

The Noble King of Tantras Called Vajra Underground

Ārya-Vajrapātāla-nāma-tantra-rāja · Toh 744 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་རྡོ་སེའུ་ག་རིན་པོ་ལུ་ཀྱི་ལྷ་པོ་ཞེས་བ་བྱ

Toh 744 in the Kangyur is a tantric scripture known in English as The Noble King of Tantras Called Vajra-Pātāla, the Vajra Underground, in Sanskrit as the Ārya-Vajrapātāla-nāma-tantra-rāja, and in Tibetan as Pakpa Dorje Sa-ok gi Gyü kyi Gyalpo. It belongs to the class of tantra texts and concerns teachings delivered by the Buddha while dwelling at the Jeta Grove in Śrāvastī, before a vast assembly of monks, gods, and bodhisattvas including Mañjuśrī, Ākāśagarbha, and Samantabhadra. The text's title evokes the imagery of a subterranean vajra realm, suggesting esoteric content related to tantric cosmology and ritual. As a king of tantras, it represents one of the more elevated and comprehensive categories of Buddhist esoteric scripture preserved within the Kangyur.

In the language of India: Ārya-Vajrapātāla-nāma-tantra-rāja. In the Tibetan language: The Noble King of Tantras called Vajra-Pātāla, the Vajra Underground.

Homage to the guru and to Mañjuśrī.

Thus did I hear. At one time the Blessed One was dwelling in Śrāvastī, in the temple of the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta — the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada — together with a great Saṅgha of monks numbering one thousand three hundred and fifty, together with an assembly of gods, and together with a Saṅgha of bodhisattvas. Among those bodhisattvas were: the bodhisattva Vimalamati, the bodhisattva Acintyamati, the bodhisattva Sarvamatī, the bodhisattva Matīvardha, the bodhisattva Trailokyavikramatī, Ākāśagarbha, Samantabhadra, Mañjuśrī in his youthful form, the bodhisattva Atreyaputra, Amitaśara, and the bodhisattva great being Avalokiteśvara — these and others, sixteen thousand bodhisattvas in all. Among the śrāvaka Saṅgha were: Subhūti, Kātyāyana, Kāśyapa, Uruvilva-Kāśyapa, Maudgalyāyana, the great Maudgalyāyana, Gajavimala, Śāradvatīputra — these and others, twenty-eight thousand śrāvakas — all surrounding the Blessed One and arrayed before him. Furthermore, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, mahoragas, and great serpents had also gathered into that assembly and were present to hear the Dharma.

Then at that time the Blessed One, in the midst of that assembled maṇḍala of the retinue, spoke to the bodhisattva Vimalamati: "Vimalamati, do you perceive this great radiance in the eastern direction?"

Thereupon the bodhisattva Vimalamati rose from his seat, arranged his robe over one shoulder, placed his right knee upon the ground, bowed his head to the two feet of the Blessed One, and addressed the Blessed One in these words: "Blessed One, I do see it. I seek to know about this immense radiance that spreads out from the face of the eastern direction — Blessed One, what is this radiance of such a kind?"

Then again the bodhisattva Vimalamati spoke once more to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, I humbly request you to declare who has produced this great light."

When these words had been spoken, the Blessed One, with a gentle smile, said these words to the bodhisattva Vimalamati: "Vimalamati, here the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi — filled with joy and contentment — is surrounded by his own host of luminous wisdom-bearers, and also by thousands of asuras, rākṣasas, flesh-eaters, and elemental spirits, arrayed before him, and this is the radiance of his wish to come to this assembled maṇḍala of the retinue."

Then at that time the bodhisattva great being Vajrapāṇi arrived there at that very same assembled maṇḍala. Upon arriving, he touched the feet of the Blessed One, circumambulated the Blessed One three times, and stood to one side.

Then the Blessed One, knowing that he stood to one side, asked him with delight and gladness: "Vajrapāṇi, if you wish to speak briefly before me, you must apply yourself with diligence for the benefit of all sentient beings, and without doubt you will come to full understanding."

When the Blessed One had spoken those words, the bodhisattva great being Vajrapāṇi looked up at the Blessed One again, then gazed out over the entire assembled maṇḍala of the retinue, lowered his head, and remained there without saying a word.

Then the Blessed One, seeing that Vajrapāṇi stood there in silence, spoke these words: "O great holder of the vajra, Victor of kings of knowledge (vidyārāja) without measure, who overcomes all others by his power — since the minds of the entire retinue have become joyful and eager, speak! Speak!"

When the Blessed One had spoken those words, Vajrapāṇi addressed the Blessed One thus: "Blessed One, if you grant permission, I shall call out to the lord of asuras named Anyaharaṇa, and, surrounded by his great asura retinue, he has gone to his own abode. Blessed One, I saw there in that place the halls, the gateways, the staircases, the upper terraces, the courtyards, the great lakes, the ponds, the pools, the wells, the doors, and the doorways that I had previously gone to examine. Blessed One, I had previously examined that place by means of a special meditative absorption, and by that very yogic practice I had entered into the supreme meditative concentration. And there the lord of asuras Anyaharaṇa, possessed of miraculous power and strength — immeasurable and inconceivable, O Blessed One — whose body pervades the sky through his divine sport, the great bodhisattva who has conquered the three worlds: why has such a being entered into meditative concentration? Blessed One, since there is not the slightest displeasure in my dwelling, for what purpose has he entered into meditative concentration? Please deign to declare this."

"Then that lord of asuras described all the magical illusions, the mechanical contrivances, the doors and panels, and the like. Blessed One, in order to overwhelm them, I described the great-light-holder, the great wrathful vajra called Vajra of the Subterranean — he who has become the master of masters of all mechanical contrivances, who destroys all one hundred and eight mechanical contrivances, who pacifies them, who causes their downfall, who utterly shatters them. Blessed One, may this be known to you accordingly. I spoke this with a joyful countenance, for the benefit and happiness of the many, so that in future times, at the very end of the last of the five-hundred-year periods yet to come, the Blessed One may bring peace to those sentient beings who have no refuge, and so that the perfection of generosity may be perfectly fulfilled — I shall describe this destroyer of all one hundred and eight mechanical contrivances, this Vajra of the Below, this master of masters of all contrivances."

Then the Blessed One spoke these words to Vajrapāṇi: "Vajrapāṇi, what you have said is difficult for living beings to accomplish."

Vajrapāṇi replied: "Blessed One, what I have described is not difficult to accomplish. Please grant permission, Blessed One. Please grant permission, O Sugata. Blessed One, I shall not speak of anything difficult to accomplish. That which enables one to accomplish the mechanical contrivances of the lord of asuras Anyaharaṇa with ease — this I recall, and I shall explain it. Blessed One,

please grant me your permission for that."

When he had spoken thus, the Blessed One spoke these words to Vajrapāṇi: "I grant permission. You, Vajrapāṇi, shall speak of it." Vajrapāṇi, for the benefit of the many, for the happiness of the many,

for the sake of perfecting the perfection of generosity through skillful means, spoke thus: "Teach the great secret of the master of mechanical contrivances together with its ritual procedures."

Then Vajrapāṇi, having received permission from the Blessed One, repeatedly sounded a rattling sound, raised his vajra aloft, and entered into the meditative absorption called "Garland of Blazing Vajras." He then recited the secret mantra of the vajra underworld:

Namo ratnatrayāya. Namaś cuṇḍa vajrapāṇaye mahāyakṣasenāpataye. Oṃ hrīḥ potri vajrapātāla hana matha bhañja pātaya mācīrama vajrakrodha hūṃ phaṭ.

Then the great wrathful vajra deity illuminated everything with rays of light, and this great earth shook in six ways. The asuras and the daughters of asuras, crushed by the wrathful vajra deity, found themselves without refuge and fled to where the Blessed One was. Having reached him, they touched their heads to the feet of the Blessed One, and spoke these words with prostrations: "Blessed One, please protect us. Sugata, please guard us completely. The wrathful vajra deity has utterly overwhelmed us. Blessed One, when this wrathful vajra deity spoke, all the mechanical contrivances in our dwellings ceased to exist, all the locks vanished, and all the doors flew open. Blessed One, sentient beings who had not yet arisen came into being. Blessed One, please command us: how are we to conduct ourselves here?"

The Blessed One declared: "Friends, have no fear, have no fear. Rely upon the sacred pledge of Vajrapāṇi. In that way you shall dwell in happiness."

Then the Blessed One looked upon Vajrapāṇi and spoke these words: "Vajrapāṇi, teach the wondrous sacred pledge to the lord of the asuras and the rest, and put them at ease."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, Vajrapāṇi addressed the asuras and the wives of the asuras: "Here, first, those who enter into the sacred pledge of the maṇḍala of the underworld belonging to the great wrathful deity Vajra of the Underworld — for them, the herbs, powders, roots, compounded medicines, alchemical substances, mercury, elixirs, the virgin, the cavities of

the asuras, methods of entering through doors, the destruction of all mechanical contrivances, and the means of desiccating them — all these will be easy to enter upon and accomplish. Otherwise they cannot be accomplished. Therefore one must enter into the maṇḍala of the underworld."

He then spoke to the asuras: "The ability to enter through cavities, the domain of the tantra of ritual action, alchemical transmutation of gold, antidotes to poison, underworld substances, and the attainments of the field — just as one enters one's own dwelling, these shall be accomplished through the specific power of the vajra. Otherwise, without beholding the maṇḍala, one will suffer failure. The various activities of the methods of accomplishment spoken of in this great king of wrathful vajra deities' own ritual procedures, and those spoken of in other tantras — these are not to be performed. Nor is one to accomplish them by desiring the ritual procedures of other ritual systems."

When he had spoken thus, the asuras and the lord of the asuras were filled with joy and delight, utterly satisfied and gratified. They themselves beheld the maṇḍala of Vajrapāṇi, gave rise to renunciation, and became servants of all the Blessed Ones.

Then the Blessed One, the bodhisattva and great being Vajrapāṇi, gazed upon the maṇḍala of the assembly with divine vision and proclaimed the maṇḍala of the sacred pledge: "Having carefully examined a favorable location of ground in a village or city, beginning from the direction of the sovereign lord, one lays out with stones, gravel, and

bones, and then, using the powders of five pigments corresponding to auspicious constellations, one draws with perfect precision a square maṇḍala, four cubits on each side, with four gates and six desire-offerings. At the gates and the intervals between the gates, one places vajras and white mustard seed. In the eastern portion one draws the Blessed One, the buddha. In the north, the Lord of the World. In the south, Vajradhara. In the west, the banner of the supreme bull accompanied by his consort. In the zone of the sovereign lord, Vimālamati holding a fan in his hand. At the fire corner, the essential nature. In the zone of the wretched body, the attendant. In the wind zone, the All-Karma. In the center, Vajrādhipati holding in his lower hand a vajra and a skull-staff — one draws these. For the essential nature and the attendant, one draws a staff and a vase. For the All-Karma, the vajra. At the eastern gate, one places all medicines, all ornaments, mercury, essence-extraction substances, asura maidens, articles of accomplishment, and the like, along with

eye-salves, red arsenic, a sword, and a jewel as the foremost. At the southern gate are eight asuras: Mighty One, Son of the Mighty One, Blessed Bliss, Thagzangri, Bountiful, Rim of Time, Taker of Others, and Thorn-Eater. At the western gate, one places one hundred and eight yantra-machines (yantra). These are drawn in eight forms: thread, curved blade, woman, lion, ram, bow with arrow, water-stream, fire, a flame-spark, and the self-nature yantras. At the northern gate, one draws vases in eight forms, and these are: the form of a ram, the form of a makara, the form of an elephant's face, the form of a serpent, the form of a rat, the form of a human face, the form of a maṇḍala, and the form of an unworked face. At the intervals between the raised platforms, one draws four gateway-openings. In the fire direction there is a fire-hearth. In the zone of no-truth there is a hearth for incense. In the intervals of the wind there are water-hearths. In the zone of the sovereign lord, one places a tortoise. Then one offers all perfumes, all flowers, all incenses, and torma and offerings for all spirits. Then, having anointed their limbs with sweet fragrance, heroes and brave men, their faces veiled with extremely fine cloth, perform the rites of the master of yantras and proceed — entering through the gates of inviting, summoning, requesting the approach, and so forth. At this point the maṇḍala drawn in colored powder is to be exhibited. The hero who thus beholds such a maṇḍala, upon being granted the master's permission, and knowing the sacred pledge, binds himself with the mudrā of the master of yantras or with the mudrā of the asuras, and thereby achieves mastery. He will enter into the households and consorts of the asuras. Substances of supremely distinguished excellence beyond all yantras made by the Taker of Others will come under his mastery.

This has been the first chapter — the chapter on the maṇḍala of the sacred pledge of Vajrādhipati, the Vajra Wrathful King — of the Blessed One, the Vajra-Holder.

Then again, what becomes mudrā and mantra is this: with the fingers interlaced and the thumbs made in the form of a snake's head — this is the mudrā of the Tathāgata family. The mantra is: JINA JIK. In the direction of the ally is the mudrā of the heart-essence of the Lotus family. The mantra is: Ā RO LIK. In the southern direction: RATNA DHRIK. In the northern direction: PADMA DHRIK. The mudrā of the heart-essence of the Vajra family, and the mantra is: VAJRA DHĀṂ K.

With the little finger and ring finger joined and brought to a single point, and the index finger placed as a threatening gesture — this is the root mudrā of

Vajra Subterranean. The mantra is: NAMO RATNA TRAYĀYA, NAMAŚ CAṆḌA VAJRAPĀṆAYE, MAHĀYAKṢA SENĀPATAYE, OM HRĪḤ PO HRI VAJRA PĀTĀLA HANA MATHA BHAÑJA PĀTĀYA, MĀ CIRAM VAJRA KRODHA HŪṂ PHAṬ. With the root mantra and mudrā, one consecrates the entire body.

From the palms held together in homage, the tips of the ring fingers are joined and the little fingers concealed; the tips of the middle fingers and thumbs are joined; the left index finger is hooked from outside; the right index finger is curled in the form of a vajra — this is the mudrā of the Vajra Enemy-Subduer.

The right hand and left hand are placed evenly together, with thumb and index finger joined; the right thumb covers the nails of the three fingers, and the left index finger, held level, is placed at the base of the right thumb — this is the mudrā of the Noose. It belongs to the left hand. OM VIBHINDA VIBHINDA NA HŪṂ PHAṬ SVĀHĀ — at the heart. OM VAJRA PĀTĀLA HŪṂ PHAṬ — at the crown. OM HAḤ VAJRA HŪṂ PHAṬ — at the crown of the head. OM HRĪḤ BANDHA BANDHA SVĀHĀ — the armor. OM VAJRA VAJRA SAHĀ ŚRĪ ŚIRA SEJVALITA ANALA HANA BHAÑJA UTKAṬAYA HŪṂ PHAṬ — this is the mantra for binding the boundaries. These are to be combined with the root mudrā.

With the palms held flat and even, thumbs and little fingers joined, and the remaining fingers formed into the characteristic mark of the vajra — this is the mudrā of All-Actions of the Three Grounds. The mantra is: NAMO RATNA TRAYĀYA, NAMAŚ CAṆḌA VAJRAPĀṆAYE, MAHĀYAKṢA SENĀPATAYE, HIRI MIRI BHIRI RIṆI SVĀHĀ. These are to be applied individually.

With the fingers interlaced and the hands formed into a fist, the middle fingers extended and joined, the index fingers slightly bent outside them, and the two thumbs placed in the center — this is the mudrā of the Great Lord of Sovereignty. The mantra is: NAMAḤ SAMANTA BUDDHĀNĀṂ RUDRĀYA SVĀHĀ.

From that very mudrā of the Great Lord of Sovereignty, with the index fingers extended — this is the mudrā of the goddess Calanī. The mantra is: NAMAḤ SAMANTA BUDDHĀNĀṂ UMĀYE SVĀHĀ.

From the opened palms, the tips of the little fingers are joined; behind them the ring fingers are joined; at their third joint the two middle fingers are joined; and at their first joint the two index fingers are joined — this is the mudrā for empowering all asuras. Both are to be combined together with the characteristic mark of the vajra.

The mudrā for destroying and dispersing the mechanical contrivances of all asuras is formed here by reversing all the fingers into the form of a tortoise — this is the tortoise mudrā. When placed on the crown of the head, it is the mudrā for empowering all asuras.

With the left hand placed below and the right hand placed on top of it, with the thumbs held separately — this is the mudrā of the tortoise empowerment.

With the left hand placed in the manner of a vajra, and the right hand placed as a downward-pointing vajra, then brought together facing directly forward — this is another tortoise mudrā.

The upper and lower hands are reversed, and at the heart the fingers are turned upward with the thumbs pressed together flat — this is a tortoise mudrā. With the vajra, pressing the lower index finger flat on top — this is the mudrā of Vajra Subterranean.

With the index finger of the fist extended, and the thumb placed on top of the middle finger and ring finger — this is the mudrā of the staff. From that very same position, with the thumb placed at the base of the index finger — this is the mudrā of the hammer.

With the hand formed into a fist and the middle finger and thumb joined evenly — this is the mudrā of the crow's beak.

With the left hand placed in the manner of a vajra at the side of the heart, and the right hand raised aloft in the manner of a vajra, while the legs remain in alternating extension and flexion — this is the mudrā of the vajra-scold.

With the left hand formed as a single-pointed vajra and placed at the side of the heart, and —

the right hand sealed with three fingers and held in alternating extension and flexion — this is the mudrā of the vajra-scold of another. The mantra is: *Oṃ vibhinda vibhinda hūṃ phaṭ*.

This concludes the second chapter of the noble tantra Vajrā Subterranean, the chapter on mantras and mudrās.

Now, when a courageous hero-man wishes to enter the glorious gateway, he should first perform the approach practice of the wrathful vajra deity, and only thereafter make his entry. The approach practice to be performed beforehand consists of reciting eight hundred thousand mantras while subsisting on begged food and maintaining silence. With a mind of loving-kindness toward

all sentient beings, and with joy in making offerings to the Tathāgatas, one constructs a stūpa of the dependent origination formula — the essence of dependent origination — and before that stūpa, at a place that may be a mountain, a confluence of rivers, a solitary tree, the precinct of the bull-deity, the edge of a forest, or any suitable stūpa site, one cultivates the awakening mind in recollection and makes supplication to all the Tathāgatas, confesses misdeeds, dedicates without remainder to the unsurpassed, recites the sacred Dharma, commits it to memory, remains in attendance upon the work of the stūpa, casts aside attachment to body and life, performs the mudrās three times daily, receives empowerment, and bathes three times daily. One should perform the approach practice in precisely this manner.

As for those who have not yet seen signs in a dream or directly perceived them, one should not yet enter. The dream signs are these: being overwhelmed, pressed down, chased, or felled by a great mighty elephant — if one sees such things as these, then at that point one may enter. Or, as for direct perceptual signs: a gateway threshold being struck and broken, a great stone falling, an angry great planet being summoned, or the appearance of venomous creatures, fierce beings, terrifying ones, nāgas, great mighty elephants, lions, tigers, or buffalo — if one has gone into the midst of enemies and yet becomes difficult to behold — and if all of these have turned into minds of loving-kindness, then at that point one may enter. All the gods will become obedient servants.

This concludes the third chapter of the noble tantra Vajrā Subterranean, the chapter on the preliminary approach practice of the king of wrathful deities.

On recognizing the characteristics of apertures:

Those waterways that have no summit,
that resound with the sound of the earth,
and that have the appearance of a lookout dwelling —
the characteristics of Vajrā Subterranean
are thus to be discerned by the wise.

By whatever mode and manner
apertures are described:
upon entering, one feels a sense of oppressiveness,
and when one proceeds into that aperture,
the ground becomes entirely level all around —
this is the glorious gateway fully revealed.

Bearing the finest fragrance of camphor,
pervaded by entwined vines and creepers,
and having a hue that is oily and lustrous —
that is what is called the glorious gateway.

Fragrant, with its surfaces moist,
growing turbid through warmth,
becoming agitated again and again
merely by being entered —
know that to be the glorious gateway;
mercury is there shown to be present.

One who enters the mouth of the aperture
finds that mind becomes filled with desire.
When it has turned into a wrathful mind,
a beautiful woman abides in the aperture.
One who is fearless, possessed of pride
and a mind of confidence —
if upon entering there one is satisfied,
the aperture is filled throughout with white substances.

Those apertures in which one who is improper, arrogant, wrathful,
without compassion and possessed of greed
abuses others in turn —
or at the mouth of the aperture
insects have made their dwelling —
that is known to be a lookout aperture.
In that aperture, good fortune is difficult to find.

Those apertures where one sees white-actioned birds
properly residing at the entrance —
there a thousand women dwell,
gold in its many forms abides,
jewels, pearls, coral,
and precious things of many kinds,
along with substances of many elixirs,
reside in that supreme aperture.

That aperture at whose entrance
the sound of ankle-bells rings out —
that aperture is filled with riches;

a thousand women dwell therein.

That aperture at whose entrance —

If a small bird is seen dancing and residing there,
that aperture is known to be without fruit —
the wise should not enter it.

That aperture in which a two-footed creature
is seen properly resting within —
the skilled one should enter there
with great enthusiasm.

There resides the supreme elixir of immortality,
which, when drunk, frees one from death.

Those who, at the entrance of an aperture,
see an elephant properly positioned
and then no longer see it —
that aperture accomplishes all tasks.

If those entering that aperture
behold the lord of glancing lizards,
a hero should not enter there —
it seizes life immediately.

If the howl of a frightening she-wolf
resounds near the aperture,
one should not be heedless there,
for one's retinue will be struck with terror.

That aperture in which a crane
is heard crying and is found to reside —
that aperture is filled with everything,
adorned with all desirable things.

Those who see a fish
properly positioned at the entrance of an aperture —
they should enter there with diligence
and will become master of a thousand women.

A young woman with a pot in her hand
is seen properly at the entrance of an aperture —

know without doubt that all the tasks of the aperture
will be accomplished there.

When one enters upon the tasks of an aperture,
if a great thunderous sound arises,
know that aperture to be without limit —
it is shown that accomplishment will follow.

At the entrance of an aperture,
if rats and white ravens
are seen dwelling there together,
that aperture accomplishes all tasks.

At the entrance of an aperture, especially,
if the fragrance of cloth arises there —
a thousand times a thousand women,
nine hundred and seven hundred,
along with elixirs, gold,
and jewels of many kinds abide there.

Where the karavīra flower blooms
and quicksilver is present there —
the skilled one should take it up.

That aperture in which a female lizard
is seen to reside —
know that aperture to be without a mechanism,
and one should not investigate it.

One thousand women and twelve hundred,
soft as the heart of a lotus,
dwell there in perpetual enjoyment.

All are of a single form,
and all who behold them rejoice.

There are many jewels,
garments and ornaments,
the chief of elixirs,
and beautiful things of many kinds.

Then aloewood, collyrium, quicksilver,
and various beautiful weapons —
all these are in the chief settlement of the aperture.

If, within the inner side of that aperture,
a wisp of smoke is seen seeping out,
know that gold in its many forms
and quicksilver are there.

On the flank of that aperture,
if a brahminī duck of varied colors
or one white by nature is seen resting —
that aperture too accomplishes all tasks.

A crow that emerges with tears dripping from its eyes —
that is shown to indicate an aperture
abundant with many kinds of food.

Where a buffalo is seen,
especially one the color of a cloud,
the skilled one should enter there
with earnest effort.

Together with the intoxicated,
one should perpetually go into that aperture
with sword in hand.

Everywhere in the north,
the quicksilver there is to be known
as deep and cloud-colored.

Where there is the fragrance of flowers,
and especially the scent of meadow incense,
it is shown that women reside
within that aperture.

The one who enters should especially
have no hesitation there.

Then five kinds of enclosures,
a royal gateway and a horse's descent,
pillars of golden nature —
all adorned with jeweled women.

Elixirs and jewels
abide there without fail.

At the entrance of an aperture, especially,
where there is the fragrance of lotus —

know that to be an aperture that takes from others,
adorned with every desirable thing.
One possessed of austerities (vratas) should enter there;
one without austerities, never.

There, many kinds reside —
whatever one desires, examine it well.
At the entrance of an aperture, especially,
wherever the scent of honey is present,
on every side of that aperture
bees will be found there;
have no hesitation about that.
The bees and such that dwell there,
and especially knowledge-holders —
to those who have accomplished mantra, they will offer no resistance.

At all the aperture's entrances,
wherever a fragrance as of butter is present —
all the great spirits of the earth, however many they may be,
and the ocean especially —
the foremost of all asuras,
the foremost of men,
and also all the yakṣas:
the supreme aperture is where all of them dwell.
The one who is a knowledge-holder and enters there
will obtain every desire.

Within an aperture where the scent of wool is present —
know that aperture to be free of mechanical contrivance,
adorned with every desirable thing.
A male tortoise and a female tortoise
dwelling and dwelling there together within the aperture —
that aperture too is free of mechanical contrivance.
There, eleven parts of quicksilver are found;
that is the excellence of the aperture.

When apertures are excavated
and a hollow channel is seen within,
that aperture is full of jewels —

the skilled one should enter there.
Upon entering, one will see
a plain that extends for half a league in length,
with a beautiful meadow therein,
and light like the radiance of the Jambu river.
There, a person will obtain the fruit:
one will live for ten million years.

Wherever a woman holding a lamp
is found dwelling within an aperture —
know this to be that aperture's sign;
it will be filled with quicksilver without doubt.

At the entrance of an aperture, especially,
wherever the smell of flesh is present —
know that to be the aperture of rākṣasas;
one possessed of wisdom should not enter there.

Near the mouth of an aperture, if a dancing
peacock is seen — know that aperture
to be free of mechanical contrivance,
adorned with every desirable thing.

At the entrance of an aperture, especially,
wherever blood is seen —
one should enter there alone,
fearless as in one's own home.

Wherever there is the smell of fish,
and especially also the smell of fat —
let the skilled one who applies effort there
diligently enter.

If upon entering one sees a flowing stream,
it bestows the fruit of every desire.

On the side of it, a fine dwelling
most excellently adorned,
a divine hall and a wooden hall
conspicuously decorated with banners —
there, fine jewels will be found,
and women lovely as beloved companions,

and much quicksilver therein —
of all this, have no doubt at all.

Wherever, when apertures are excavated,
a rain of blood falls —
one should not enter there;
it will immediately steal life away.

When examining and investigating an aperture,
wherever darkness is found —
enter there without fear;
that aperture is like one's own home.

At the entrance of an aperture, especially,
wherever the scent of cloth is present —
there, many jewels,
quicksilver with red sandalwood likewise,
fine eye-medicines,
ornaments of jewels
in many varied kinds,
and gold in many forms will be found.

Within apertures wherever
the scent of a lamp is present —
one should also enter there;
all desires will be obtained.

On the side of an aperture,
wherever poison is dwelling —
that is certainly the abode of flesh-eaters,
and it is undoubtedly the dwelling of ḍākinīs as well.

Wherever the cry of "haha" resounds,
oriented toward the direction of the lord of power —
know that aperture to be frightful;
one should flee from it swiftly.

Wherever there is the sound of noises filling the space,
properly oriented toward the eastern direction —
if one applies effort there,
that aperture too accomplishes all works.

In the surrounding environs of that aperture,
wherever a rain of vajras falls —
know that to be quicksilver;
it accomplishes the aims of all sentient beings.

In the surrounding environs of that aperture,
an aperture fragrant with flowers —
know that to be free of mechanical contrivance.
it accomplishes all desires.

Within the environs of that aperture,
wherever there is the sound of the Victor —
know that aperture to be free of mechanical contrivance;
the skilled one should enter there.

In the surrounding circuit of that aperture,
wherever one sees an excellent horse —
there too the hero should enter.

Whatever treasure lies in that aperture,
wherever one sees a naked man,
large black charnel grounds —
if seen and then no longer seen,
that aperture too accomplishes all works.

Wherever one sees a naked wandering ascetic,
a bald head, or a long nose,
or wherever one sees a dog —
that is taught to be the place of accomplishment.

In the surrounding circuit of an aperture
where there is the scent of a female animal —
know the extent of that aperture's vein-channel
to be one hundred leagues.

Wherever the characteristic of three points
is seen in every direction —
ordinary people cannot
particularly enter that aperture.

Wherever one sees a brahmin adorned with fragrant flowers,
know that aperture
to be free of mechanical contrivance —

the fruit of all desires is accomplished.

Resting properly at the mouth of the aperture,
wherever there is a white snake —
applying effort there,
the skilled one should enter.

In the surrounding circuit at the mouth of the aperture,
wherever one sees a bear —
know that aperture to be free of mechanical contrivance;
it accomplishes the aim of all desires.

While performing the work of the aperture,
wherever a pig is seen —
know that aperture to be free of mechanical contrivance;
it will infallibly yield treasure.

In the surrounding circuit at the mouth of the aperture,
wherever there is a watery scent —
know that to be quicksilver;
it benefits all sentient beings.

In the surrounding circuit of that aperture,
wherever there is the scent of incense —
know that aperture to be free of mechanical contrivance;
it will infallibly yield treasure.

Dwelling at the mouth of the aperture,
wherever there is the scent of molasses-beer —
know that there are women of precious beauty,
and food and drink.

In the surrounding circuit of the aperture,
wherever there is the scent of a goat —
there too the hero should enter, but not casually;
one should enter without intoxication
and remain there as long as one wishes.

One endowed with faith, pure, and skilled,
distinguished by one's conduct and deeds,
should pay homage to the Three Jewels;
likewise, with especial veneration, to the lord of mantra,

the mantra king, the goddesses,
and the assembly of mantra practitioners.

Oṃ vara vajra hūṃ phaṭ.

This is the essence of the noble Vajra-Underground. It is likewise the proximate governing principle of all activities.

Oṃ hrīḥ hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ vibhinda vibhinda hūṃ phaṭ.

This should be recited for protection at the time of offering, on the side of a gate or a mechanical contrivance.

This is the fourth chapter, illustrating the characteristics of apertures, from the Tantra of the Vajra-Underground.

Now, if a mantra practitioner wishes to enter the glorious gate, he should first recite and purify, and then enter. What, then, is the recitation and what is the purification? First, one applies old earth, water, and medicine to the body. Then, with this supreme medicine compounded in equal portions from kumuda, utpala, ruṭa, nirguṇḍī, and āragvadha, one destroys rākṣasas and poisons, fosters the growth and development of the young, clears obstacles to the fire offering, guards against the rākṣasas of Brahmā, and protects against seizure by malevolent and desiccating forces. Applied to the intimate parts of those whose bodies have been seized by a decaying spirit or of women whose wombs have been harmed, this will make them well again. And those whose limbs have been anointed with these may even drink the poison halāhala. Those who anoint their limbs and enter thereby will find the gate released; once that which obstructs the gate is freed, wind that has been held back for a long interval will also emerge. That constitutes the recitation. As for the preparation: mātuluṅga, karaṇja, and

Block the door of the pit with wood from the nyagrodha tree and other such timbers, leaving no gaps, and cover it completely on all sides with door panels, then set it alight. That the fire burning inside is completely extinguished constitutes the preparation.

Then a hero-practitioner, having anointed the area around the maṇḍala with a thick paste of fresh yellow clay without allowing any to fall, performs worship at the mouth of the pit and carries out the torma ritual. He kindles fire in the wood of the apāmārga plant and, stringing together the fruits of apāmārga with butter and honey, the master of the yantra offers one hundred and eight

fire oblations. By this, all yantras will fall into ruin and be destroyed.

Next, wearing a garment of goatskin, at sunrise he anoints all his body and that of his entire retinue with the medicine, performs the appropriate acts, and enters together with virtuous companions.

Regarding the yoke prepared with two parts of licorice and white kaṭuka mixed with kaṭuka: it is said to vanquish the pride of serpents, to accomplish the object of intense desire, to protect young men, to render women fortunate, to dispel all torments of desire, to pacify quarrels, to grant prosperity to the lord of the land, to vanquish all enemies at all times, and to bring things under one's power at sunrise.

In this connection: one anoints the body with these, dons a garment of goatskin, takes up a razor, and makes a torch from the hollow stalk of a śalmali tree in order to dispel darkness. Reciting the yantra-mantra twenty-one times in full, one lights it. If it takes the form of a rat, use rat's fat, and the crocodile's fat as before. If it takes the form of an elephant's face, use elephant's fat, as before. If it takes the form of a hawk, use hawk's fat, as before. If it takes the form of a human face, smear human fat onto the top of the śalmali stalk torch and hold it in the direction of darkness. One smears the fat corresponding to whatever face appears there, recites the yantra-mantra twenty-one times, and lights the fire. All darkness and deep gloom will be destroyed.

When entering, one also anoints those who accompany one.

The powder of the following — flowers of tagarā, costus, spikenard, cardamom, utpalāvatī, siṃghī, vyāghrī, namaskarī, anantā, jayantī, peacock's crest, and conch flower — is said to destroy all illusions, to reveal them, and to burn them away.

In connection with water, giving, likewise with essence-extraction, the small tent for drum-beating, the virulence of poison, the lotus lake, summoning the daughters of asuras, bringing under power, causing women to descend, and likewise their dwelling places or elsewhere: a hero-practitioner recites the yantra-mantra twenty-one times and presses it in. When entering water, or when surrounded by poisonous smoke and poisonous winds, one anoints oneself thoroughly from the soles of the feet to the crown of the head and then enters. From all of these dangers one will be protected. While entering, one recites the yantra-mantra. Reciting it as one enters, no one can withstand one — like the majesty of Vajrapāṇi — as if one were entering one's own home.

Taking goat's milk and sugar together with vajratantula, one mixes them, recites the wrathful mantra twenty-one times, eats it, and enters.

When there is an offering of food to the god in a temple of the Great God (Śiva), one sets out from there, circumambulates it keeping it to the right, and enters while reciting the yantra-mantra. Upon entering, one recites the mantra twenty-one times over the drum-beater and strikes with it. If, when the sound of the drum is heard, a gathering of women does not come, one then sits on the southern ground of the Great God's temple and recites the yantra-mantra. At that very instant, the entire gathering of women will come straight there, and, having arranged the offering articles, the hero-practitioners enter.

Having entered, one sends a letter-message saying: "Stay for as long as you live." One should recite continuously, always keeping in mind the Three Jewels and the noble Vajrapāṇi. In this way, one remains in the midst of women for as long as the sun, moon, and stars abide. When one wishes to depart, one anoints oneself with a compound medicine, then takes up quicksilver, an essence-extract, or whatever siddhi-substance one desires. From the yantra of the bow, one withdraws and recites the mantra seven times over white mustard seeds, then thrusts with them. If even then one does not fall, one thrusts from the southern root of that yantra. Then one will fall. First one sends the retinue on ahead, and oneself enters from behind. One lights a fire from the fire-offering hearth at the lamp-pillar offering shrine and enters. By reciting the master-mantra of the yantra eight hundred thousand times into the wells, the doors will emerge. Moreover, in those wells, for the one appearing in the form of a palm-tree snake, one prepares pills made under the Uttarāṣāḍhā star-conjunction, mixing together equal parts of stainless eye-medicine, camphor, costus root, bālā herb, valerian, long pepper, and musk — the supreme medicine known as poison-vanquisher — and a person of wisdom thrusts them in. One then becomes a palm tree itself. This was declared by the Blessed One Vajrapāṇi. This is the fifth chapter, the chapter of the solitary yantra as spoken by the noble Vajrapāṇi.

Then the Blessed One entered into meditative absorption together with Vajrapāṇi, the Lord of Secrets, in the sphere of activity of the Tathāgata. Then the Blessed One declared to Vajrapāṇi, the Lord of Secrets: "Vajrapāṇi, in order to crush the arrogance of all the asuras and to establish them in their sacred pledges, proclaim these vajra-wrathful sacred pledges!"

Then Vajrapāṇi rose from his seat, drew his robe over one shoulder, placed his right knee on the ground, bowed to the Blessed One, joined his palms, made obeisance, and spoke as the Vajra Wrathful One. The moment he spoke, the king of the Vajra Wrathful Ones blazed up in a single tongue of fire, filled the three worlds, and emitted a great roar. Then, seeing such a great sign, all the asuras together with their retinue thought: "Here the gods and asuras are about to do battle," and the asuras assembled — Vemacitrin, the Powerful One, Vairocana, Prahlāda, Bali, Kālakañja, Śambara, Kūrma, and others with their retinues, as well as the Great Impassable One, Lightning Tongue, Rāhu, the Garland of Light, Vidhipāda the golden one, and others, together with hungry ghosts and the forces following in the train of the asuras — all gathering together with their mounts and armies and arriving at the place where the Blessed One was.

The gods too, upon seeing such a great sign, each speaking their own thoughts to the other divine hosts and to Śakra (Indra), arrived at the place where the Blessed One was, joined their palms, and stood to one side.

Then the Blessed One declared to Vajrapāṇi, the Lord of Secrets: "Vajrapāṇi, if you know the moment has now come, then bless this place today with the empowerment called 'The Drum-Sound of the Lord of the Underworld.' This will bring benefit, purpose, and happiness to the many. Blessed One, I have blessed it by displaying the sacred pledge for the sake of sons of good family who have faith in the Great Vehicle. Blessed One, may the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and fully awakened buddha grant his blessing. Other Tathāgatas too have granted their blessing."

"I too shall bless it." Standing to one side in the direction of the Lord of Power, one should clear that supreme place by removing many sickles and stones, dismantling mechanical devices and cutting down trees. Furthermore, one should abandon places where fumigation offerings, divine fire-sacrifices, maṇḍalas and empowerments have been performed, places where obstructing spirits, misleading demons, and yakṣas have been propitiated, and places consecrated as sites for the Saṅgha's empowerment ceremonies. Having thus cleared all such places, one should mark out therein the water-rich directions by indicating pools, lakes, ponds, mountains, and oily or fertile ground. These should then be swept and thoroughly purified as before. One should draw a square, four-gated design in the five colours and establish the centre of the maṇḍala at the eighth part. Vajras consecrated with white mustard seed are to be placed at the four corners.

In the centre, the Blessed One, the buddha, is to be drawn. To the right of the Blessed One, the noble Vajrapāṇi bearing a flaming vajra is to be placed. Beside him, the wrathful king Vajra-of-the-Underworld holding a vajra battle-staff is to be placed. To the left of the Blessed One, the bodhisattva Immaculate Intellect bearing a flywhisk is to be placed. In front of the Blessed One, the Great God (Śiva) together with his consort is to be placed. In front of him, the chief of birds looking downward, clad in dark garments, is to be placed.

At the eastern gate, all medicines are to be set out: Eravatī, Meṣavatī, Jyotirasā, Begavatī, Sūryavatī, Ajagandhā, and Yakṣakanyā — these eight great medicines are to be placed. Their forms are to be drawn in order at their respective stations: a lion, a chief of birds, a vulture, a tortoise, a frog, a crane, blazing fire, and quicksilver. The medicines are to be placed in the form of quicksilver, of essences, and of noble women. Ornaments, accomplished substances, red dye, eye-medicine, musk, a fine vase, leg-balm, offerings held aloft, a wheel, a sword, a staff, a trident, a lasso, and so forth are to be drawn.

At the southern gate, eight asuras are to be drawn: the Powerful One, Son of the Powerful One, Supreme Bliss, Rim of Time, Thagzangrisi, Supreme Ease, the Taker, and the Club-Eater.

At the western gate, a void of more than thirty mechanical devices is to be placed. Among these, eight great mechanical devices with their forms are to be placed, namely: a cord, a hooked knife, a woman, a ground-device, a hand grasping a balance-pole, the posture of looking downward, and a gaze directed at a ground-device — these are to be drawn. Then, figures in the form of a lion, a ram, a water-monster, an elephant, a serpent, the form of the maṇḍala, an unworked face, and these eight auspicious gates with their forms are to be drawn. A device of a face with closed lips is to be drawn. A device in the form of a peg on the head of a ram is to be drawn. A bow together with arrows and a peg at the navel of a water-current are to be placed. A square frame of gift and radiance together with a surrounding device is to be drawn. Forms of sleep and of emanating light are to be drawn. Then, in order, devices with their forms, pierced through with pegs, are to be drawn.

At the northern gate, owls with their forms are to be drawn: the faces of a lion, a ram, a water-monster, an elephant, a serpent, an ox, a maṇḍala, and an unworked face — these eight auspicious gates in forms pierced with pegs are to be drawn. In the centre thereof, a water-current staff is to be drawn. At the

four corners, four gateless doors are to be drawn. This is the fire-pit of the blazing fire.

The fire-pit of smoke without truth, and the fire-pit of water as wind. In the powerful station, a serpent is to be placed.

Then four fine, fragrant, white-cloth parasols are to be set in place, together with a vase blessed by a jewel fitted with a stalk, filled entirely with pure and extremely fragrant water, free from black roots, and anointed all over with sweet fragrance.

At the eastern gate of the four-cornered outer maṇḍala, in a single dwelling, the great and powerful lord of the asuras (demigods), Tobchen, and the great Drokka are to be drawn. To the south of that, Illuminator and Hāritī's Piṅgalā are to be drawn. At the western gate, Luminous Garland and the great drum — these lords of the asuras are to be drawn.

Then four meatless divine food offerings are to be made: the first to the Buddha, the Blessed One; the second to Vimalamati; the third to Vajrapāṇi; the fourth to the King of Wrathful Ones; the fifth to the Great God.

Then, according to one's means, tormas offerings are to be given to the lords of the asuras and tormas to all spirits.

Then divine food offerings of all fragrances, flowers, powder, and the like are to be given.

Then the mantra for binding the gods to the earth is: Oṃ vajra-garbhe vajra-garbhe phaṭ hā-dhi-ki-ri-ṇi svāhā.

Then, at the four boundaries, the hands, sealed with the mudrā and consecrated, are to bind and draw in the demonic misleaders.

The mantra for this is: Namaḥ samanta-vajrāṇāṃ oṃ vajra-pālaye svāhā — to be recited three times.

Binding and drawing in with a vajra iron chain is to be performed. Buddhas, bodhisattvas, and all gods are to be drawn in with flowers.

Nama-traya-dhvikṣanāṃ sarva-tathāgatānāṃ anala-bhākānāṃ namaḥ svāhā.

Then the heroic man is to be guarded by this mantra: Oṃ dūrbāre jvala jvala namo vajra-sāgarāya svāhā.

Having been thus guarded, his face is to be covered with fine, fragrant, white cloth. The master of the device is to recite, and the heroic man, holding an

unlit wooden stick like a Dharma boat, binds his right hand with the turtle mudrā or the asura mudrā. Then, reciting the master of the device's words, he is to be empowered at the eastern gate with water from a vase free of black roots and furnished with fine leaves.

Following that empowerment, a flower is to be cast with the hands forming the vajra mudrā. Whichever god's domain the flower falls upon, that divine family is accomplished.

Then the face-covering is to be removed, and the heroic man who has been empowered is to be shown the maṇḍala by the heroic master.

Upon seeing the abodes of the lords of the asuras, their weapons, mercury, essence-extract, assemblies of women, substances of attainment, and their maṇḍalas, one will enter into the samaya assembly of gods and asuras. Even without having previously performed approach practice, the device will be destroyed. They will not play nearby. Through that device with its many forms — the houses of all the asuras, mercury, essence-extract, women, weapons, ornaments, illusions, and various mechanisms — one will gain mastery.

Whether it be illusions projected by magic, emanations of asuras, or otherwise the devices and mechanisms assembled by sages and accomplished ones — one will become able to cause them to fall and bring them under control.

For those who wish to enter the gateway of glory, first the vajra wrathful one is to be recited, and then, having spoken the gateway of glory and purified by burning and so forth —

Anoint the maṇḍala with yellow ochre, perform the torma ritual, and then kindle fire on an apāmārga-wood fire in a hearth shaped like a mouth. Offer in fire one thousand eight hundred fruits of the apāmārga plant. By this, all mechanisms will be brought to ruin.

Then, wearing a garment of donkey-hide and holding a weapon in hand, bind a lamp-stand with the hide of a cow, fill it with the fruit of the śalmalī tree, and kindle fire in the ghee of the jyotiṣmatī seed with this mantra: oṃ dūpi dūpi prajvalini svāhā. Or else, in whatever form a hollow appears, kindle fire therein with this mantra and recite the sovereign mantra of the mechanisms. All darkness and deep gloom will be utterly vanquished.

Anoint the bodies of all those who move together with you with the following medicines: Chinese bdellium, saffron, costus, valerian, cardamom, mulikā, daṇḍotpala, siṃghrī, vyāghrī, namasakarī, ananta, jayantī, and peacock crests.

The powder of these, called "that which destroys all illusions," is to be used in water mechanisms, fire-offerings, mercury, essence-extract, entering among women, and summoning the daughters of asuras. Performing the minor ritual, recite the sovereign mantra of the mechanisms, then anoint the feet well with it, and all mechanisms such as the fire-offering and the rest will manifest.

Before entering into that, first rinse with vajra-tantulī and eat it together with sugar, then enter. Do not disturb the gods of the divine hall. Circumambulate the divine village from the right side and proceed. Enter the drum-hall. Beneath the drum, draw the mudrā of the tortoise. Recite the sovereign mantra of the mechanisms one hundred and eight times over the staff, press down with the left foot, and while reciting the king of wrathful ones, strike. Before entering, take up the offering water, the foot-water, and the libation, and those who do not come will there certainly die. Yet they will unfailingly come.

This was proclaimed by the Blessed One Vajrapāṇi himself.

Alternatively, press foot upon foot atop the mudrā, face toward the inscription, bind the mudrā, and recite a short while. All that dwells beneath the sole of the foot, and the daughters of the asuras, will assuredly come. They will bestow mercury, essence-extract, and substances of attainment exactly as desired. Then dwell together with them for as long a time as one desires.

Thereafter, when one wishes to depart, take up whatever beautiful substances that benefit sentient beings one desires, and proceed without doubt to wherever one wishes. Then, having drawn the form and shape of the mechanism in the mind and bound the mudrā of the asuras or another mudrā, recite. In that very instant a great light will arise and the door will be set free. Go without hesitation wherever one desires. By immeasurable power one will overcome adversaries. Swift as thought, one will tame even the most difficult of kings to tame.

Thus declared the Blessed One Vajrapāṇi.

There is no empowerment other than this — called "the Vajra-Jewel Subterranean Maṇḍala," which is meaningful, for conferring empowerment upon the leaders of the asuras and upon heroic beings.

This is the sixth chapter, "The Chapter of Meaningful Activity," from the text called "The Mudrā and Maṇḍala of the Vajra-Jewel Subterranean."

Then, from the Vajra Subterranean, one should explain well the empowerment that has been proclaimed. One should write out the drum-tones of the secret subterranean maṇḍala. Then place the tortoise mudrā upon a bed of white mustard seed. Having performed the ritual of offering —

A vase adorned with fine cloth, its base not blackened, filled to the brim with precious medicinal substances — one should offer the ritual cake (torma) with a clockwise circumambulation, then place it upon the mudrā. By means of the ritual described previously, one should consecrate the maṇḍala with blessing. Having invited the gods, one should make offerings as is appropriate. Having aroused the awakening mind (bodhicitta), one should also confess one's misdeeds. Then, having sealed with the vajra mudrā, one should perform the empowerment with the accomplished vajra water outside the secret maṇḍala. In accordance with whatever empowerment is being conferred, one should arrange vases of the corresponding kind. For whichever maṇḍala ritual is described as a mudrā and torma rite, one should, by diligent effort for the purpose of empowerment, bind the mudrā and remain in that state. Having performed the approach practice beforehand, one should abandon the activities of mercury. According to the way of following the sūtras, one should perform the rites of the stūpa. Being fully liberated together with all one's companions, eating by begging and remaining in meditative equipoise, one will swiftly attain accomplishment. May Vajrapāṇi grant his blessing.

This is the seventh chapter, "The Chapter on the Empowerment for Accomplishing the Noble Vajra Subterranean."

Then here is to be explained the ritual of the painted image of the great wrathful one, the Blessed One Vajra Subterranean, who is worshipped at the feet by the three worlds. Thread spun by a young woman should be washed in cow's water and woven by a weaver who abides in the eightfold restoration ceremony (poṣadha). When it has become cloth, within the span of the mantra-master's cubit — and the dimensions being one cubit and eight finger-widths wide — a painter who observes the eightfold restoration ceremony should be engaged under protection, and worship water should be offered.

One should paint the Blessed One Akṣobhya — of the blue-black color of the utpala lotus, wrathful with red eyes and lips pressed together, the three seats trembling, brow furrowed in a wrathful scowl — adorned with bracelets, a waist-belt, anklets, armlets, and a precious crown; with matted hair in a

topknot; holding a garland of fresh human heads; bearing in worship a circlet; ears adorned with coiled earrings; seated in the lotus cross-legged posture atop the matted-hair topknot; in the manner of one proclaiming the Dharma. In his first right hand, a brilliantly blazing vajra; in his second right hand, an iron hook. In his first left hand, he grasps a lotus-treasury filled with a wish-fulfilling jewel; in his second left hand, the finger-gesture of threatening the asuras (demigods). He abides alone and matchless in the middle of a great ocean, seated upon a great lotus. Beneath his right hand, he is to be painted with a hand adorned with lotus stems, one knee raised upon an accomplishing lotus.

Then, in the places described earlier, having performed appropriate consecration and worship, one should recite one million times before a stūpa that contains relics. After that, one will be able to perform all activities. The painted image should be placed at the auspicious door, as desired.

One possessed of auspiciousness, wearing red garments, seated on a cowhide mat, should mix poison and blood and, using a ladle of human bone, pour it in and perform eight hundred fire oblations. All the mechanisms of enemy machinations will be destroyed. Defeat of enemies, mercury practices, essence-extraction, and the ability to enter the city of women will all come about. The mechanisms of action will be accomplished according to command. By the mudrā, all gods will be summoned. By such means, all intentions as one intends, all activities as one intends, and all rituals as one intends will be performed according to command. They will listen to directions.

Whoever paints a king of nāgas, then lays out the painted image before it and presses down upon it with the left foot, should recite one hundred thousand times.

That king of nāgas will come and say, "What do you command?" One should say to him, "Do as I bid." He will then listen to whatever is directed. One will be able to enter the dwellings of all nāgas. All of them will listen to commands given to do this or that.

In the same way, all low-bodied spirits, yakṣas, elemental spirits, rākṣasas, and the yakṣa-women of the winged beings and the like will all act according to command. They will listen to whatever is directed.

Gather earth from the tip of an anthill seven stories high. From it, make a garuḍa image, and before a reliquary containing relic essences lay out a painted image. Seated upon it in a hermitage or any other suitable place,

recite one hundred thousand times. One will be able to travel upon it. One will attain the power of great Nārāyaṇa. One will perform great magical emanations. One will become the wheel-turning sovereign over all vidyādhara (mantra-holders who have accomplished everything). Just as one who accomplishes all things, there will come measureless lifespan, mastery over death, birth in buddha-fields as one wishes, and from there, passing on again, one will, through the power of meditative absorption, be taken up and guided by a spiritual friend who is a bodhisattva. The noble Vajra-Underearth tantra causes a great cloud to fall, and within all that lies beneath one's feet one becomes sovereign over all awareness, conduct, and all sources of precious things — a bestower of the highest, a holder of the wheel — a single supremely courageous great king.

This was declared by the Blessed One Vajrapāṇi. This is the eighth chapter, accomplishing all things, from the noble tantra Vajra-Underearth.

Then the supremely secret painted image worshipped by all the asuras shall be described. An artist who observes the restoration ceremony should paint with unmixed colors on cloth woven by a young girl whose threads are uncut and who has not had her hair cut, placing the colors in a new vessel. The figure is red, with four arms, ornamented with a girdle of snakes, holding a snake-offering vessel, with lips pressed together like a fresh cloud, with a frown drawn on the forehead, bearing a garland of heads crowned with a vajra. In the right hands: a chopper and again a vajra. With the left hand's threatening forefinger, he illuminates the opening of the palace of Śrī; in the second left hand he holds a great wrathful noose in a coiled posture. He gazes downward. His face is bared in a grimace, with teeth showing — fierce in form. He should be painted in the manner of one who has no devotion. In the direction that is void or empty, where there are flowers and fruits, or at the threshold of the palace opening, recite six hundred thousand times. Before this, the painted image should be arranged so that no malicious person whatsoever can see it. Then burn the ground with wood struck by vajra lightning, and in that direction apply white mustard seeds fully consecrated with the fierce vajra mantra. Then take up the seed that has appeared there. Next, kindle fire in the vajra-struck wood, and in the fire-pit shaped like a vajra, mix those mustard seeds with red sandalwood and pour them as an eight-thousand-offering fire oblation.

On the fourth day, a woman dwelling in the city of the asuras will certainly come, warmly disposed, and will make a display. One should not engage with

those women. One should not speak with them.

On the fifth day, at the conclusion of the fire oblation, smoke will arise from all the maṇḍala mechanisms. Then those women will come and say, "Please, brave hero, come here." Even then, one should not engage.

When the fire oblation has been performed and the sixth day arrives, smoke will begin to pour through all the chambers. At the place of the maṇḍala mechanism, there will be a sound of kīṭi kīṭa. Then those women, with eyes brimming with tears, will come bringing all the substances of accomplishment and all precious things.

One should display one's own mudrā and then receive them. If one is still unwilling, then on the seventh day the fire oblation should be performed. All those who entered before will die. All the maṇḍala mechanisms will fall and be destroyed. They will cry out in lamentation and will certainly come. Grant them fearlessness, and only then engage with them from outside.

This is the ninth chapter of the noble tantra Vajra Beneath the Earth, the chapter on fierce conduct toward the daughters of the asuras.

Then, further, what is revealed in sequence: the Blessed One himself transforms, wearing a tiger-skin garment as a lower robe, with four arms. With two hands he pierces the head of the great asura Grahana and strikes him dead with a vajra. The right hand pierces with a hook of iron, in the manner of extracting a flower with fingertips shaped like the fangs of a crocodile. The left hand makes the threatening gesture with the index finger. Before him, a tree pierced by a vajra blazes with fierce fire. A six-pointed vajra adorned with flowers and fruit — for the duration of a single day, together with the syllable PHAṬ — is to be burnt. By burning it, the women of all the asura clans will come crying out in lamentation, without refuge. One will then engage together with them.

Now there is a deity known in the world as the Left-Facing Goddess. From a mixture of fat, the three heating substances, and powdered barley, one makes an effigy of her form. One lights a fire in the vajra-pierced wood, then drives a vajra into the heart of the effigy and fans the flames for as long as it can stand upright. If it does not rise, one lights the same wood in a fire pit in the form of a vajra, chops it into pieces, and performs the fire oblation. All the maṇḍala mechanisms, by the mere touch of that smoke, will fall and be rendered without the power to arise again.

This great secret should not be given to those who have not seen the maṇḍala, who do not know the rites, who have not purified karmic obscurations, and who lack samaya. It should be given to those who have accumulated merit, who have destroyed the maṇḍala mechanism of the apertures, who possess an enthusiastic mind, who have a mind free of fault, who are respectful to their father and mother, who have aroused the awakening mind, and who have undivided devotion to the Tathāgata.

This is the tenth chapter of the noble tantra Vajra Beneath the Earth, the chapter on inscribing on the crown of the asura lord Grahana.

Then, further, yet another practice is to be explained in sequence: while eating food of leaves and barley, and eating the food of one who begs, one should recite three hundred thousand times in the manner described before. When the recitation is fully complete, one paints on the vajra-pierced wood an image of a wrathful vajra being — furiously frowning, lips pressed tight, terrifying, with a hand raised holding a vajra, the left index finger making the threatening gesture — and then, when the great moon is seized by an eclipse and darkness falls, one installs it in a charnel ground on a seat of red sandalwood, or in mud on a riverbank. Having made a great offering before it, and having made a six-fingered, five-pointed vajra from the vajra-pierced wood, one makes offerings of incense and flowers and whatever offerings are available, and prepares a ritual cake. This is then placed on top of four leaves of the aśvattha tree and covered with three leaves.

One draws a vajra on the palm of the left hand using charcoal from a charnel ground, then covers the ritual cake with that hand. Reciting the mantra continuously, for as long as the earth does not move, one accomplishes the rite. By holding that very vajra in the hand, one destroys the mechanical devices of all cavities. This was declared by the Blessed One, Vajrapāṇi.

Now, if one wishes to draw women out from within, one places that wrathful vajra at the entrance of the auspicious cavity, kindles a fire with charnel-ground wood, holds the vajra in the left hand, and with the right — rather, not with the right hand — performs a fire offering of eight thousand white mustard seeds. The women will then come forth. One takes them by the hand and leads them inside. Or else, whatever one desires will be granted. By reciting two million one hundred thousand times, one destroys all manner of firm and variegated diagrams. This was declared by the Blessed One, Vajrapāṇi. This is the twelfth chapter, on accomplishing the vajra, from the

lower tantra of the noble Vajra.

Now, the accomplisher of this medicine must accomplish it by all means. It eliminates obstructors and misleading influences. One takes the following substances — moonrise herb, indrahoma, singhri, bhyāghri, the fourth hand, bharahakarṇika, gajādaka, racani, costus root, saffron, and conch powder — and grinds them in elephant urine, then forms them into pills of whatever shape one wishes. One places incense, flowers, ritual cakes, and fumigants in the prescribed locations. When washing with water and removing impurities, one binds it with a cloth. One makes offerings with incense, flowers, and the like. Otherwise, misleading influences will enter and cause harm. When the medicine just described is used against misleading influences and the like, everything is thoroughly undone; they look at one another and say these words: "For as long as this medicine exists, we shall not go there" — and they scatter in all directions near and far. Within the range of one league, no obstructors will arise. All activities will also be accomplished. Whatever knowledge-holder anoints themselves with it at the three times of day, no one will be able to enter into them.

An incense compound made by combining bālaka, sārivā, lobramā, lāṅgalī, garlic, and mouse hair — if prepared with effort — will, when placed at the entrance of the cavity as one passes through, quell drops of falling moisture.

A medicine prepared by grinding together blue lotus, fragrant butter, costus root, sarabi, sandalwood, bolaka, and cow urine destroys poison, and destroys the heat-moisture diseases arising from the entrance of the auspicious cavity.

Water wood, spikenard, bāṇa, kostha, udumbara, bala, aśvagandhā, white chalk, and white gerikarṇika — combining these destroys drowsiness, mechanical devices, and darkness for all.

An eye-medicine prepared by combining śibhāñjana seeds, lotus, nāgakeśara, and camphor in equal parts eliminates sleep.

An eye-medicine prepared from kara, horse saliva, nāgakeśara, and saripa, combined with the recitation of the wrathful mantra, repels mechanical devices by itself.

Combining peacock crest feathers in equal measure and tying them with a white linen thread, one recites seven times, and this repels conflict.

For one whose mind is free of distraction, who is endowed with kindness, who knows the Dharma, and who has long vision — in whose home the medicine is

placed with proper ritual and with supreme reverence for the wrathful vajra beneath the earth — for such a one the auspicious cavity beneath the feet will be accomplished. Of this there is no doubt.

Excellent flowers, and —

Flour of field peas, white mustard, bāla, and asafoetida — each one measure — are mixed together with sugar, and reciting twenty-one times, one repels the mechanical device of famine.

The seed of apāmārga, the seed of vibhītaka, and pills of udumbara — reciting seven times over these — dispel famine.

Taking the sap from the leaf of an elephant's ear, one combines it in equal measure with vajra-face and vajra-milk, cooks it with sesame oil, and with that supreme essence of fat one should anoint all the joints.

The blood of the vajra tree,
and likewise the essence of the vajra trunk,
combined with the essence of the śēbalā —
cook these with golden butter.

First, having held these things within,
the skilled one remains with earnest application.
Anointing the body with grain-oil,
one should then walk upon the joints.

Asafoetida and cat-fat,
barley of the snow,
mixed evenly with horse sweat —
these one should cook with horse urine.

If the body is anointed with these,
it will not be contaminated by the joints.

This is the thirteenth chapter — on medicines and elixirs — from the noble tantra Vajra Beneath the Earth.

Then one should enter the hollow with the gaze of a lion. The skilled one should read the signs: at the auspicious door, the presence of four-footed animals, mercury, extracted essence, women, and accomplished substances pervading it completely.

As for hollows — those that are spacious,
some filled with stones:

these are called self-sufficient.

Where the earth burns and water dries up,
where the smell of dung pervades from outside,
filled with the bones of skeletons,
and packed with venomous insects —
these too are to be known as self-sufficient.

Some are filled with mud,
others full of stones and water,
with many trees of unpleasant smell —
these will be frightful, producing fear and dread.

Smelling of excrement and decay,
some have in them the smell of snake,
filled with hides and birds —
these are definitely places of rough clearing.

Or else, just as is taught in Vajra Beneath the Earth, the skilled one should
examine the outer characteristics in the manner described, and then enter.

Equipped with all implements,
the supreme wrathful mantra one recites well;
with empowerment, having been empowered,
the wise one should guard it carefully.

In this manner the hero
enters the auspicious door beneath the earth in the heavens above —
there, without doubt, one enters,
and thereby all desired fruits will be obtained.

With that hero, greatly inspired,
giving and loving and pure,
without arrogance, free of manifest pride,
with a mind supremely free of fear —
seeing flames of fire and great omens,
with a mind free of suffering,
firm as a vajra —
though difficult to accomplish, one should accomplish it.

This is the fourteenth chapter — on the examination of mechanical devices —
from the noble tantra Vajra Beneath the Earth.

Then furthermore, a further unfolding of the sequence for entering the auspicious door:

Going toward the mechanical device,
very swiftly but without haste,
placing the feet with effort,
one should observe the mechanical device from all sides.

When the mechanical device sways,
or moves, or shakes,
or else bears weapons —
arrows, śakti-lances, and clubs,
swords, discus-weapons,
whatever one sees wielded by the mechanical device,
or the edge of a curved blade, of a knife —
and likewise beings such as sheep and so forth —
when one sees such appearances,
one should carefully bind the mudrā.

With white mustard,
or upon ashes with wrathful intent,
reciting the wrathful mantra seven times,
the skilled one thrusts it at the mechanical device —
without fail it will fall.

One should enter the divine palace. Those who have become as great gods there behold the tormā-offering of hungry ghosts. However hungry they may be, they do not eat it. There, with certainty one sees — without moving even for a single instant, at that moment not speaking — sealed by a thousand asuras. Having seen that, with a frog's

reciting with the seal seven times, one stirs it. Then, with a nature that is clear and pure, one bows with reverence and respect, and says: "Welcome, heroes! Please enter at your ease."

The preparations of the rites of accomplishment include: many kinds of precious substances, mercury and essence-extract, jewels and women, and, moreover, swords and weapons filling the interior. Taking these from their hands, one demonstrates how to be at ease. By the blessing of Vajrapāṇi, there one acts as one desires. For as long as one dwells there, one sports with the daughters of the asuras. Led by the path they show, one departs with

certainty at ease. One goes at ease to the asura city, and returns again at ease.

As for those who went there before: pressed by the vajra that lies beneath the earth, if they do not return, they will die there in bewilderment. Therefore, the wise one should not press those who have entered that passage before.

This is the fifteenth chapter, the chapter on entering the Glorious Gate, from the noble tantra of Vajra Beneath the Earth.

Then follows the sequential exposition of the realization of the Glorious Gate.

Remaining outside the Glorious Gate, one who has wisdom perceives its characteristics with discernment, refraining from speech, from begging and eating, possessing a mind free from agitation. Three hundred thousand times the wise one recites, relying upon the Glorious Gate.

By the first hundred thousand recitations, the mechanical devices will fall. By the second, the earth trembles and great smoke rises in turmoil. By the third, the asura daughters arrive with ornaments and neck-bands loosened, radiating warmth. When scorched by the wrathful fire, thinking it is the fire of an aeon, they cry out and flee in all directions. Then, in order to pacify them, through a fire-offering of clarified butter mixed with sandalwood, their bodies come to rest in ease, and their minds deeply bowed in submission.

At that Glorious Gate there reside: wealth and swords, swords with eyes of patched iron and so forth, mercury, fine essence-extract, and a hundred thousand women. "You, our master, please act as lord over all of this. Above and below it is excellent. Even if you do not enter there, do as you wish." Placing before one the accomplished eye-medicine and so forth, pressed by the vajra with its variegated pattern, it is given as though placed directly in one's mind. Having taken whatever one desires, that is what one should release. There one draws the maṇḍala together, pleases the gods, then requests the wrathful one to depart as well. Reciting one hundred and eight times, one departs at ease.

Putting on a great armor, the one endowed with intelligence takes power, and casting aside miserliness, wrath, remorse, jealousy, and the like, by being always joyful, whatever activity one performs will be accomplished excellently. This was spoken by the Blessed One, Vajradhāra.

This is the sixteenth chapter, the chapter on wrathful conduct at the Glorious Gate, from the noble tantra of Vajra Beneath the Earth.

Then follows the sequential exposition by means of other characteristics.

First, one recites three hundred thousand times. Then, at the mouth of the tunnel, with a body of pleasant fragrance, one eats milk and barley porridge and recites three hundred thousand times. Then all the mechanical devices of the tunnel will be destroyed. Then, with a mind free of doubt, one makes one hundred and eight fire-libation offerings at the mouth of the gate and enters — just as one would enter one's own home.

The great secret proclaimed by the lord of the asuras through another's taking — the great secret Glorious Gate beneath the earth, taught by the Blessed One Vajradhāra for the sake of all sentient beings:

The vajra-wheel, likewise, the three-pointed, the water-lily, and the lotus —

The auspicious and the conch, and the makara — these are to be understood. The vajra passes through the yakṣas; the wheel passes through the rākṣasas. To the palace of the nāgas, one goes by the three-pointed; beneath the feet, by the water-lily; along the great highway, one goes by the lotus; through the auspicious house to the treasury tunnel; through the makara to the women's quarters.

This is the seventeenth chapter, the chapter on characteristics, from the noble tantra of the Vajra Beneath the Earth.

Then comes the explanation set out in the sequential stages of the knowledge-holder's yoga practice.

When one has passed beyond the darkness and a lamp shines brightly, that place is called a mechanical device. An intelligent person should not proceed to that place. In order to destroy the mechanical device, the mudrā of the raised vajra is to be applied. Lifting the right foot, it is placed over the left. At the navel center, with a fist, one turns it with a dancing movement. Raising the right hand, it is pressed against the left. The hand above looks downward; outside, this presses it. With mustard seed and ash, by pressing, the earth will shake, and the mechanical device will become loose. Then, by pressing once more with it, it will inevitably collapse. Having placed the feet level, the left hand is set at the heart. Having performed a dance outside that place, one presses it with whatever is at hand. An irate deity bearing the syllable Hūṃ, having been ground to powder, falls to the ground. By the rite of the raised vajra, whatever mechanical devices have fallen to the ground will never arise there again. Know this as a tunnel free of mechanical devices.

Whatever aerial mechanical devices have been described, and wherever a wind of poison arises, by this very rite, at the mere sight of it, they will collapse. That wise master who knows the sacred pledge, should he behold a divine abode, by skillfully pressing with the mudrā of the raised vajra, turning and casting it forth, the elemental spirits are to be summoned. In the same way, the sacred pledge itself is to be shown. One who has attained accomplishment through empowerment, and who has beheld the activity rite — to him alone is this to be revealed; otherwise, one will die.

The medicines of the Glorious Gate, the eye-ointments made from mercury and so forth, and likewise women — in that very place, they will not appear. The treasury, the gold-transformation tunnel's gate, and likewise bringing them under one's power — these too cannot be obtained merely by seeing them, even by an intelligent person who lacks empowerment.

The rites of the asuras, and the maṇḍala of the Vajra Beneath the Earth — having guarded the maṇḍala of whoever has entered it accordingly, one offers a fee to the lama and makes offerings of perfume and flowers. Having filled a vessel with vajra water, with others holding vases whose necks are bound with fine cloth, one confers empowerment with those characteristics.

Then, binding the tortoise mudrā, whether the mudrā of blessing or likewise the asura mudrā — by the authorization granted by the lama, all aims are accomplished. The opening and thorough opening of the asuras and the mechanical devices adorned with illusion is accomplished by the knowledge-holder.

Not by a mechanical device, not by poison, not by water, not by fire, not by elephants and so forth, not by serpents, not by the four mechanical devices directed against them, not by sword, staff, or muṇḍa, not by an emanation of the river Añjaka, and not by the many other diverse mechanical devices — none of the supports found at the secret boundaries can exert even a slight influence against this, when it is pressed by empowerment and pure sacred pledges and their blessing. Through its power, by reciting even just a little, all mechanical devices are destroyed. This is what the knowledge-holder consecrates through the family.

Therefore, with every effort, empowerment is to be applied. Through it, all aims and accomplishments will be obtained, and the gods themselves will bestow their blessing upon it. Base activities are to be abandoned, and the rites of coercive magic are likewise to be forsaken — the works of subjugation,

of bringing down, and of domination, and the rites of spirits as well, all are to be cast aside. One who is possessed of intelligence should recite continuously, by means of a meditative absorption free from affliction.

This is the eighteenth chapter, the chapter on knowledge-holders, from the noble tantra of Vajra-Subterranean.

Then shall be taught the supremely secret maṇḍala consecrated by the wrathful king Vajra-Subterranean. One faces toward the quarter of Empowerment and establishes the site. At the outermost edge of the town, at the boundary of the city's quarter, one removes stones, bones, shards, inferior charcoal, ash, brine, pig bristles, wood impaled by yakṣas, many old scythes, leaking water, and heaps of broken pots. On an auspicious day, having secured a guard, one marks out a square of four cubits and four sides, with a gateway-chamber at the threshold of each gate, and the center of the maṇḍala being circular in form, circling to the right. At the four inter-cardinal boundary points the maṇḍala is not circular. Having examined it carefully, one consecrates the drawing with the vajra. In proper sequence one draws the great ocean, the abode of the kings of the asuras. One who is endowed with intelligence draws the auspicious gateways. One marks with a plumb-line the places for: the forms of jewels with their defining marks, the sites of the mechanical devices, the medicines, the mercury, the essence-extractions, the substances of accomplishment, the provisions, the offering-cakes, and the filled vases. Then, at the center of the maṇḍala, the buddha, the Blessed One, is to be placed. To his right is Vajrapāṇi. Close beside him, the wrathful one Vajra-Subterranean is to be placed, holding a vajra-hammer in his hand. To the left of the Blessed One the bodhisattva Vimalamati is to be placed, holding a fan. Then, below Vajrapāṇi, in front of the Lord accompanied by his consort, is to be placed one who possesses the supreme stallion. Then, at the first pilaster of the eastern gate, all medicines, mercury, essence-extractions, ornaments, and goddesses are to be placed. Then, at the southern gate, eight asuras are to be placed: Balin, son of Balin, Sukhottama, Parāpara, Kālāntaka, Takṣaka-design, Prasimha, and Daṇḍabhakṣa. Then, at the western gate, one thousand three hundred mechanical devices are to be placed, and there one draws eight mechanical devices with their forms: the thread, the curved knife, the woman, the lion, the sheep, the bow with arrows, the water-stream, the offering ladle, and the sleep-device. Then, at the pilaster of the northern gate, one draws eight circular apertures with their forms: the sheep-face, the crocodile-face, the elephant-face, the serpent-face, the rat-face, the

human-face, the form of the maṇḍala, and the form of the unworked face. Then, below the inter-cardinal points consecrated by the vajra, four gateless spaces are placed. At the corner of fire is a fire-hearth. At the corner of wind is a water-hearth. At the corner without truth is an incense-hearth. At the corner of Empowerment is placed a serpent-form. Then, having invited these, the great wrathful vajra that brings-down consecrates them. Four vases — free of black roots, endowed with five branches, five medicines, and five precious things — are bound at the neck with fine, sweet-smelling cloth without hair upon it.

At the four inter-cardinal points consecrated by the vajra, white mustard seed is used to consecrate and place them. Then vajra water, flowers consecrated by mudrā, incense, butter-lamps, a bell and so forth, and divine food offerings are to be presented.

Then divine food offerings of various flavors, fruits, and well-prepared fruit of the king of grains — without alcohol or meat — together with pleasing and excellent tormas offerings are to be given and touched to all spirits in the directions and inter-cardinal points.

Having performed the mudrā and maṇḍala rites according to the ritual procedure, one recites by following with the mind the wrathful king, the sole hero, beneath the vajra.

For the purpose of consecrating the heroic man, he enters beneath the mudrā of the asuras (demigods), and armor is consecrated from the soles of his feet to the crown of his head. As for how it does not fall — thereafter, having fumigated with fine fragrance and incense, the face is veiled with fine white cloth, the hands are joined in the vajra-palms mudrā, both feet are placed on the ritual boat, the offering is presented, and the ears, consecrated by the sacred pledge, become equal to the sacred pledges of the buddha family, the Dharma family, the Saṅgha family, and the bodhisattva family — and to those whose pledges have been opened.

Having heard such a pledge as this, the flower is to be cast. Whatever deity's family it falls upon — that is one's deity family. First, bound with the mudrā and consecrated, the offering is to be presented to that one.

Then, having gathered the maṇḍala with the mudrā of the vajra-lasso, the deities are to be requested to depart according to the ritual procedure, through mudrā and mantra.

Then, having seen the maṇḍala: being consecrated by the supreme sacred pledge; being consecrated by all secret mantras; going forth excellently; obtaining the accomplishment of all desired aims; being fully engaged in the Vinaya; the cessation, binding, revealing, performing, moving, piercing with the kīla, opening, and obtaining the aim of all tantras; proclaiming, analyzing, repeating, meditating, and practicing as yoga; acting with fierce power toward all malevolent ones; opening, cutting, and accomplishing the maidens and all the mechanical devices; and finding accomplished in every aspect and in all aims — all this was declared by the Blessed One Vajradhara.

This is the noble tantra composed from below the vajra: the nineteenth chapter, the rites of the maṇḍala of the Tantra Composed Below the Vajra, entitled "The Sole Vajra Hero."

Then, furthermore, set out as an elaborate sequence of rites: from wood pierced by the vajra, a vajra is made, and three hundred thousand recitations are to be performed. Then, during the month of Pisces (the fish month), offerings are to be made. Hold it in the palm of the hand and recite until it makes the sound "citi citi." Then accomplishment will arise. All mechanical devices will be destroyed. They will be burned. Then women, taking their fee-offerings, will come. Then one causes them to enter, freed from the mechanical device. Whatever substance is desired is given to it.

The Blessed One, the god of gods, worshipped and served by the gods — this glorious wrathful king, the great sovereign master of vidyā-kings, even without being propitiated, will perform the actions. Focusing on the daughter of the asuras, one recites at the lock of her door one hundred thousand times. The daughter of the asuras will be moved. Seized by unbearable illness, she will come, having fully completed the hundred thousand.

If she does not come, one performs eight thousand fire-offerings using white mustard mixed with poison, burnt in acacia charcoal. She will come. If she still does not come, one performs eight thousand fire-offerings using the red flowers of the oleander. Then, by pressing with the vajra, she will come without fail. The hero then takes her by the hand and causes her to enter. Holding the vajra in the hand, one causes her to enter.

Alternatively, one makes a wheel from wood imbued with the vajra, and in the charnel ground, mixing the charcoal of the nim tree with hot butter, one performs eight thousand fire-offerings, each offering accompanied by the syllable Svāhā. The accomplishment will occur right there. Mixing poison,

blood, and white mustard and performing eight thousand fire-offerings, the lock of the hollow will be opened. Then, smearing the area around the opening of the hollow with ox dung to form a maṇḍala, one anoints it above with fragrant substances. The vajra is then used to draw a vajra upon it. Taking that vajra in the right hand, one briefly praises the white mustard and performs eight thousand fire-offerings. She will come, freely carrying whatever substances are desired. She is to be seized. If this is not desired, one causes them to enter together with those things.

Or, if one desires to extract a treasure, one recites twenty-one times over four iron stakes, drives them into the four directions, and recites the secret mantra. A treasure will then emerge there.

This was declared by the Blessed One, Vajrapāṇi (the vajra-holder).

Namo ratnatrayāya. Namaś caṇḍavajrapāṇaye. Mahāyakṣasenāpataye. Oṃ vajre vajriṇi. Vajrottare. Vajravijaye. Vajrāparājiti. Vajrapātālini hūṃ phaṭ hūṃ phaṭ svāhā.

From wood imbued with the vajra, one fashions a single-pointed vajra of eight finger-widths. One makes a seat in the form of a vajra, sixteen finger-widths across, fashioned from red sandalwood, places the vajra upon it, and, keeping the restoration ceremony throughout, renders everything in the nature of sandalwood, and places it at the auspicious door. Eating leaves, barley gruel, and alms, one recites three hundred thousand times. Then all the mechanical devices will fall open. They themselves will come and cause entry.

If those do not come, other actions are also to be described. Holding white mustard mixed with poison and blood, eight thousand at a time, reciting each one in full and pressing with the vajra — they will then come, and seizing by the hand, one causes entry. For other actions to be accomplished by the hero: performing eight thousand fire-offerings with poison and blood mixed together, they will then come. Holding the vajra, one causes entry. Thus declared the Blessed One, Vajrapāṇi.

Then other actions are also to be described. Eating leaves and the rest, bathing at the three times of day, and with the vow of silence, one recites three hundred thousand times. Then, from wood imbued with the vajra, one fashions a vajra of thumb-size, with sixteen parts and three points, and places that vajra upon a throne of red sandalwood. Worshipping with red flowers, fragrant substances, and the like, and offering a ritual cake, one abides in the restoration ceremony day and night and presses the vajra eight hundred times

with the flowers of the oleander. Then three kinds of accomplishment will occur: a crackling sound arising from the vajra, a smoky trunk appearing in the hollow, and young women coming. When one says "Enter!" — at the time of entry, while abiding in the restoration ceremony day and night, one examines the signs. When the vajra makes a crackling sound, that is the mechanical devices being opened.

When one sees smoke arising, then all the mechanical devices are destroyed. After that, one enters just as one would one's own home. Whatever substances one desires, those will be granted. If one does not wish to enter, then at that very hollow opening one kindles a great fire in the wood of the arghā tree or the wood of the acacia, mixes white mustard seeds with one's own blood, and pours eight hundred oblations into the fire. Then the young women will come. Having come, they take one by the hand and lead one inside. They grant whatever substances one desires. Otherwise, those women will die. One should draw a maṇḍala with threads of five colors. This is the twentieth chapter, the extensive chapter, from the Vajra Underground Tantra.

Then the Blessed One, the Wrathful King, performing the ritual of the great underground, is as follows. A weaver who observes the restoration ceremony washes the thread that was laid down by a young woman with the urine of a cow, then on the fourteenth or eighth day of the dark fortnight, or in the direction free from fish, one supplicates the Tathāgata with fragrances, flowers, incense, and the like as offerings, and makes a great ritual cake and divine food offerings. One makes a painted image of the Sugata in whatever size one desires, exceeding the height of the Sugata by that measure, and worships it with a vase consecrated with jewels, medicine, and grains, offering lustral water. One makes great ritual cakes and divine food offerings, satisfies the monks who are present with fine food to the best of one's means, makes aspirational prayers for whatever accomplishment one desires, and has the image guarded by a painter who observes the eight-branched restoration ceremony. A hero gives the fee without fixing a definite price. Using unmixed colors, one paints the Blessed One, the Wrathful King, the sole hero, the Great Vajra Underground. He is like lapis lazuli, like a great cloud. He holds in his upraised hand a snake as an offering. He wears a belt made from Kubera, the king of the nāgas. His ears are adorned with ornaments of joy and strength. His arms and legs are adorned with the serpent Āśīviṣa. He wears a tiger-skin lower garment. He has three eyes. The great terrifier laughs loudly with a "Ṭaṭa!" sound, his fangs gnashing and blazing — utterly blazing with a mass of

brilliant light. He has four arms. In his right hand he holds a three-pointed vajra encircled by a great sphere of light. In another hand, with fingers curved like a hook having the form of a crocodile's face, he draws beings toward him as if with a flower stem. In his left hand is a great serpent, coiled as a noose. Beneath his second pair of hands he threatens obstructors, asuras, nāgas, yakṣas, and the like. Below, one paints a great ocean. In its center, upon a great mountain, he sits upon a great lotus — and he is the Blessed One. Within that great ocean, below the waterline with the lower half of his body submerged, one paints eight great asuras who are watching. Above the Blessed One, before a sphere of light, seated upon a lotus throne, and seated upon a wrathful throne with his arm extended upward, the great wrathful one performing an exhalation — one paints the Tathāgatas Amitābha and Akṣobhya with their immeasurable bodily light. When such a painted image is fully complete, the one who holds the vidyā (the knowledge mantra) alone, or accompanied by a good companion, obtains a place — a mountain, or an ancient cave free of sound, or a solitary tree — and there eats leaves, fruit, milk, and alms. One confesses misdeeds, rejoices in merit,

with delight in the Dharma, one consecrates the painted image and recites one million mantras. By this rite, the mere utterance of the syllable Hūṃ can reduce even Mount Meru to powder and dry up the ocean. It causes the abodes of the gods to fall. Proceeding with such prior approach practice, one places the painted image at the gateway of the glorious entrance and recites ten thousand mantras. All those who dwell nearby will come there. One commands all of them. One bestows mercury, essence-extraction elixirs, eye-medicines, accomplished substances, and the like. It opens what is closed. It renders one untouched by all giving. It silences sound. It dries up streams. All machines of war are made to fall. All evil is stripped away. A fire-offering of butter and rice causes pacification. A fire-offering of butter and milk increases strength. A fire-offering of butter and tandulea grain pacifies great illness. A fire-offering of poison and blood slays those who lead others astray. A fire-offering of neem leaves expels. A fire-offering of rat hair mixed with one's own blood summons the daughters of the great asuras. A fire-offering of mongoose hair summons the nāgas. By this rite all other intentions spoken of elsewhere are also accomplished. This was declared by the Blessed One, Vajradhara. This is the twenty-first chapter, the chapter on accomplishing all things, from the noble tantra of Vajra Underground.

Then, concerning the sequential unfolding of the victors that destroys machines of war: the lion, the tiger, the lord of elephants, the horse, the finest of horses, the sheep, the rhinoceros, the bear, the monkey, the pig, the buffalo, and the deer — these eleven emanated machines of war, thoroughly trained, suppress the firmly bound machines of war at the underground gate by raising the fist toward them.

Struck as if pierced by a vajra, they are destroyed. The owl, the crow, the vulture, the hawk, the hundred-leafed one, the great garuḍa, and the crested one — these machines of war, so widely renowned, menace the great earth, and without hesitation one pierces them.

With sword, the Muṣaṇḍī door-plank, the wheel, the serpent and the club, the man who holds the bow in hand, the razor, and the one who holds the noose — these one pierces with a great arrow wielded by the intelligent.

The wind machine, the fire machine, hunger, sleep, and trembling, head-ailments and eye-ailments — these one pierces with the canopy of the wheel.

The fourth's flashing stream, the wind of poison, and darkness, the makara, the tortoise, the rat, the frog and the wicked alike — these one cuts with the kakaru device; a man who beats an earthen drum pierces them by menacing with the vajra.

By that very same principle of the dance engagement, many other machines of war, widely renowned as wind and fire, thorns of earth and water, the poison of the sky together with them — all of these one pierces underfoot with the vajra through the dance engagement. By the engagement of the threatening vajra and the vajra-fist, one pierces them. Through piercing, all machines of war will fall without fail.

If even the Sun and the Vajra-holder himself are pierced by the glorious one and made to waver, what need is there to speak of ordinary machines of war? The daughters of the asuras are not hard to obtain.

Swords, wheels, clubs and the like, flashing light, the ajagara serpent, the door-plank of the secret boundary, and garlands of bees likewise — whatever has become a powerful sound and a great war-cry, whatever has become a means of total destruction — by that same outer rite one pierces as it destroys.

Gnashing one's teeth in fury and pressing the lips, one pierces through underground recitation. The machine of war that enters into a pit —

That was the explanation of the underground machine of war. When one sees the glorious gate — even if it be fine in appearance but its defining marks are impaired, and it has hard boundaries, concealed places, and is entirely covered with markings — then by the rite of the earth-element, with the hand placed above, reciting eight hundred times over the stone, one should strike the boundary firmly. By simply pressing upon it, that machine of war will without fail come into view.

A crow's beak, a staff, and a snare likewise — by the rite of the tortoise mudrā, one should touch it with the hand other than the right. Having bound it with a peg, one should drive it into the crow's beak. With the left leg extended or level, with the right one encircles it. One will thus find the joint of the machine of war. That must quickly be pierced. Then, drawing in the right knee, one extends the left leg. By pressing upon the peg with a hammer, the machine of war at the boundary will be set in motion. At that very moment, with the Wrathful Vajra, one should pierce it by reciting the secret mantra. When smoke arises there, it means a machine of war of wind has been constructed. From saffron, great incense, costus root, and punarnava pressed with Viṣṇu — from these one makes a fumigation offering. The machine of war of wind will thereby be reversed.

This was declared by the Blessed One, Vajrapāṇi, Lord of Secrets. This is the twenty-second chapter of the noble tantra entitled "The Victor Who Destroys Machines of War Beneath the Earth."

Then Wrathful Vajra addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, you yourself have declared the great tantra entitled Victorious Vajra. I too, for the sake of benefiting the holders of vidyā, would speak on this matter, and so I request it of the Blessed One. Blessed One, how should a holder of vidyā (vidyādhara) dwell? How should one accomplish the vidyā?" When he had spoken thus, the Blessed One, Vajrapāṇi, Lord of Secrets, declared to Wrathful Vajra as follows:

"Wrathful Vajra, you have done well, you have done well, in asking about the causes for accomplishing the vidyā for the sake of benefiting all sentient beings. Wrathful Vajra, listen — how a holder of vidyā accomplishes the vidyā. First of all, a holder of vidyā must completely uphold the five bases of training, arouse the awakening mind, and dwell in great loving-kindness, great

compassion, great joy, and great equanimity. The Vinaya of the holder of vidyā will then be explained by me.

"First of all, one should take up the recitation rosary. With a gemstone, a life-sustaining seed, a fierce pill, red sandalwood, and the supramundane fierce eye drawn from vajra-eyes — the mantra for stringing these together is:

Namo Vajrapāṇaye. Oṃ kiri kiri raum driṇi svāhā.

With this mantra one should string the rosary. Then one receives authorization from a master, offers excellent dakṣiṇā to the master, and recites the mantra. Whoever is endowed with such practice and accomplishes the mantra will certainly succeed. Obstructors will not be able to interrupt. If one has not entered into the maṇḍala, not even a word should be given, to say nothing of accomplishing the mantra. To one endowed with such qualities, the secret of mantra accomplishment should be disclosed.

"For the purpose of accomplishing pacification, enrichment, coercive action, subjugation, slaying, and expulsion, a holder of vidyā should completely take up a retreat place. The places suitable for retreat are: a mountaintop, a solitary tree, a charnel ground, and stūpas that enshrine relics. At these places, without a black-rooted vessel, one should fill a vase completely with gems, grain, and all kinds of medicinal herbs, and before the Blessed One recite eight hundred times."

Oṃ amṛte hūṃ phaṭ. In the retreat place of a yantra (maṇḍala diagram), one should recite this mantra. Then, on the earth side, the vase should be consecrated with wrathful praise and fumigated as an offering to all. Everything should be encircled with an unbroken stream of water. Poison, blood, and mustard seed mixed together should be ignited in a fire upon arjaka wood, and one thousand eight hundred burnt offerings made, declaring: "By this I have completely taken possession of this place." From that point on, neither the vidyās of that vidyā-holder nor any other will find an opportunity to enter or intervene. Then whatever one wishes to accomplish in one's mind should be accomplished.

In order to accomplish any particular rite, the vidyā-holder should eat cow's milk, barley, leaves, and whatever is begged, and facing the Tathāgata should recite one hundred thousand times. At the end of the mantra, a supplication should be made, saying: "Blessed One, I pray that you declare to me that this practice I am undertaking will without fail be accomplished." Then, in the presence of the venerable Buddha, on the eighth day of the dark fortnight and

keeping the restoration ceremony (poṣadha), one should make offerings in the evening session to the best of one's ability, seat oneself upon a bundle of kuśa grass, face the Tathāgata directly, and recite the vidyā in a whisper without interruption until sleep comes. Then, sleeping there bound on the kuśa grass, during the last watch of the night, that very deity will speak, declaring the accomplishment. If nothing is spoken, then on the following day, making offering in the same way with the full rite of offering in the presence of the Blessed One, one should recite eight hundred times over blue flowers and scatter them in the four directions, and recite without interruption until sleep comes. The declaration will certainly be made.

Then, without doubt, following the rite described before, one should recite the great secret mantra three hundred eight thousand times. After that, the fire-offering rite is as follows: for coercive action, the fire-offering platform should be triangular; for enrichment, four-sided; for pacification, round; for great accomplishment, lotus-shaped; for subjugation, hook-shaped. Along with the vidyā, fragrant flowers and the inner wood should be burned. For coercive action, one should pour oblations using charnel-ground wood, the three hot substances, marking nut, mustard seed, salt, ash, blood, and similar substances, before the wrathful deity. For pacification, the inner wood should be from a medicinal tree. For enrichment, it should be from a milk-bearing tree. For pacification, white flowers and white fragrant substances. For enrichment, flowers and yellow fragrant substances. For coercive action, flowers and red fragrant substances. One should perform the activity in three sessions with a mantra that includes homage to the Three Jewels. For great accomplishment, one should perform the activity with homage to the Three Jewels. For pacification, one sits cross-legged. For enrichment, one kneels on one knee. For coercive action, one presses foot upon foot. The oblations should be poured without eating food. For great accomplishment and pacification, the syllable hūṃ is recited. For coercive action, the syllable phaṭ. For pacification, the evening session is used. For enrichment, the morning session. For coercive action, one performs the activity at midday or at midnight, gazing upward. For great accomplishment and pacification, one faces east. For enrichment, one faces north. For subjugation, one faces north. In the presence of the Blessed Buddha one should make offering to the deity and perform the enrichment activity. For a charnel ground and for a single-sign location, subjugation and coercive action are performed. For pacification and the rest, one should kindle fire and proceed. When the fire

becomes excellent and bright, then the activity will be accomplished. At the outset, one should summon the deity through the mantra and afterward bind it. If one does not first do it that way, the vidyā will not be accomplished.

Having invoked the deity, one should count eight hundred repetitions of the secret mantra before the Blessed Buddha, facing in his direction, using a vessel filled with fragrant water and furnished with white flowers. The signs heralding the arising of the great accomplishment will then appear: if one suddenly hears the sound of a conch or the sound of thunder, or if a sweet fragrance arises, one should know that the deity of the vidyā has arrived. If it does not come, one should take up the offering water as before, in the presence of the Blessed One together with his retinue, and recite eight hundred times — it will then come. When it has arrived, one binds the maṇḍala, binds the directions, and presents the torma and the deity's food offerings. After that, one should accomplish the eye-salve, the eye-lotion, and the like. One should first purify them and then accomplish them. The eye-salve, the eye-lotion, and the like are to be sprinkled with milk day and night and then set aside. They are then removed, and one should hold a feast for the Saṅgha to the best of one's ability.

Under the lunar mansion Puṣya, one should make offering before the Blessed Buddha, wrap the substances in fine, undamaged white cloth, offer the merit-offering, and examine them. When the signs described previously appear upon examination, one should know that the activity will be accomplished. There are also other signs: if the sound of cymbals, the sound of a conch, or the sound of victory arises, then by the sound of cymbals, the great vidyādhara attainment will be accomplished; by the sound of victory, the power of moving through the sky will be accomplished; and by the sound of a conch, the power of subjugation will be accomplished.

One applies the prepared substances to nameless pills, five in number. These are placed on the undamaged cloth and dried in the shade. After that, they are placed on top of an aśvattha tree and left there for seven days. Then, on the morning of the very first day of accomplishment, one recites a thousand times over pills thoroughly moistened with the entire downfall liquid, and then proceeds to accomplish the powder. Four aśvattha leaves arranged in a rightward spiral are placed over it, and it is covered three times. The aśvattha leaves should be taken from a place of this kind: they must not be touched by the shadow of another tree, must not be touched by a divine palace, and one should by no means use aśvattha leaves from trees grown in a charnel ground.

Aside from those, the whitened tips of leaves from an aśvattha tree of a praised and excellent location are divided into three portions of the accomplished substance — one each for the teacher, oneself, and one's companions. These are visualized as vajra, wheel, and sword respectively, and dried for five sessions. They are then placed in the middle of a heap of cow dung and left there for twenty-one days. After that they are removed, washed with the five products of the cow, left there again for seven more days, then recited over a thousand times using the entire downfall liquid — eight hundred times — and one then enters into the accomplishment practice.

That eye-salve is mixed with costus root, camphor, and lodra bark, and over them one fully recites the heart-mantra of the Blessed One, Locanā, eight hundred times. When applied to the eyes during the time of accomplishment practice, sleep will not arise. A further medicine is made as follows: the white root of apāmārga, white śuddha, costus root, camphor, bear bile, saffron, and white sandalwood — these are first fasted over for three days before a stūpa containing relics, and the mantra of the Vajra Armor is fully recited over them eight hundred times. Then at the time of accomplishment, one ties them together with cow's urine and thoroughly anoints the whole body, and then enters into the accomplishment practice. Gods, nāgas, yakṣas, vidyādhara, and all evil spirits see one from afar as blazing like a mass of fire endowed with radiance.

and upon seeing it they will prostrate themselves. The accomplishment of the families of all worldly and transcendent beings will be equally achieved.

When the vidyādhara has accomplished the substance, he should then, as before, recite the mantra of the Blessed One Sphyanma eight hundred times over a white flower and place it in the center of the substance, which will thereby stabilize the substance. Otherwise, the accomplishment will be taken away.

Should the vidyādhara not succeed in accomplishing the secret mantra, he should proceed as follows. On the bank of a river flowing into a great ocean, he should construct eight hundred small stūpas — each of one cubit in height — enshrining as their essence the formula of dependent origination, and he should offer incense, flowers, and fragrant substances to each stūpa as best he can. Three times each day he should generate the awakening mind and confess his misdeeds, and before each stūpa he should recite either eight thousand or eight hundred times. If no sign has appeared, he should by this

same method construct one thousand stūpas; and if a stūpa that does not belong to the western direction blazes with light, he should know that his karmic obscurations have been exhausted. After that, everything he undertakes to accomplish will succeed.

Once the great accomplishment practice has been commenced, he must not perform rites of subjugation, killing, or the like. If he does, the vidyā will not be accomplished.

Those who are blind, hunchbacked, have a shaking palsy, are deaf and mute, have bad nails, are spotted in complexion, are afflicted in body, or have dark-colored excrement — such persons cannot accomplish the great accomplishment. They may accomplish other rites such as those connected with the planets.

The person who has faith in the Buddha and the Dharma, who is respectful, who has copper-colored nails, who is devoted to his parents, and who shows great reverence to his lama — such a one will accomplish everything.

If a vidyādhara who accomplishes mantra is engaged in practice as before and passes the time of his natural lifespan while mentally aspiring toward whatever he wishes, then by the mere act of dying he will be reborn in the corresponding condition, achieving whatever rank he desires — whether the rank of a great wheel-turning vidyādhara, or the family of a vidyādhara, or the family of a great lord of power, or the family of a caṇḍāla vidyādhara, and so forth in sequence — according to the aspiration with which he has cultivated the mantra, so he will be established in that family.

A vidyādhara who strives in the great accomplishment must not tread with his foot upon the vajra, the wheel, the trident, the staff, the noose, the short spear, the club, the lotus, the conch, the iron hook, or the water-vessel, nor upon drawings of these on the ground. The reason is this: the vajra is the vajra of Vajradhara; the wheel is the wheel of Viṣṇu; the trident is the trident of the Great God (Śiva); the staff is the staff of Yama; the noose is the noose of Varuṇa, the god of waters; the short spear is the spear of Kumāra; the club is the club of Balarāma; the lotus belongs to the bodhisattvas; the iron hook is the iron hook of Vajra; and the water-vessel belongs to Brahmā. Therefore, anyone who wishes to obtain the great accomplishment of the mahāmudrā must not tread those objects — the vajra and the rest — with the feet of the mahāmudrā.

When a vidyādhara is accomplishing the secret mantra and the deity of the vidyā does not grant the accomplishment, he should appease the vidyā by the following rite. He should make an image of the deity of the vidyā using all manner of fragrant substances, place it before the feet of the Blessed One Vajrapāṇi, and remain in fasting retreat for three days. Then on the eighth or fourteenth day of the dark fortnight, using the vidyā mantra together with a visual representation of the eye, he should strike eight thousand flowers of the namasya plant against the heart of the image; and having prepared eight thousand burnt offerings poured with black sesame oil mixed with butter, he should place them there and perform the offering rite and the torma rite as best he can. After that, the vidyādhara, gladdened, will fall asleep and the Teacher will appear to him, or guidance and instruction will be revealed to him.

If the Teacher does not appear, then on the following day he should likewise perform the torma rite and recite eight thousand times together with the vajra wrathful deity. After that, he will see that same deity of the vidyā together with the wrathful one in a dream, and deficiencies, excesses, final insufficiencies, and alterations of letters will also be revealed to him. If the practice has been perfected completely, then the accomplishment will be granted. One should not perform this rite at the very beginning of practice; rather, if after seven repetitions of the sādhana it has still not been accomplished, then one should perform this rite. When the time for the accomplishment of the substances arrives, at the end of the evening, during the night, and at sunrise, the vidyādhara should recite, calling to mind whichever mantra he wishes, as if in a dream. Otherwise, those who lead astray will enter in and the deity of the vidyā will not appear directly. He should not touch the clothing of others. He should divide a garment into three portions: wear one and perform ablutions; with the second he should recite; and put on the third at night. Sitting in cross-legged posture, upon seeing the sign of the deity of the vidyā, he should perform burnt offerings poured with sesame mixed with butter. The power of the vidyā will increase. If sesame is not available, he should use the plants known as dantula, green lentil flesh, and mudga. He should not consume fish, meat, or alcohol, for by that fault those who lead astray will overpower him. He should always be endowed with reverence toward the Buddha, the Dharma, and the Saṅgha, and he should generate the great awakening mind, the bodhicitta. One who knows the samaya vow and acts in this way will accomplish it before long. The vidyādhara should do as was described before.

He should always offer incense to all the deities and, with his own hand, offer grain of the divine food-offering. When reciting, he should face east, and he should recite before the painted image is drawn. The great size of a painted image is a canvas of ten cubits. At half of that it becomes middling, and at the last it becomes lesser. In this context the vidyādhara should do as was described before. If in exchange for a hundred objects he is offered substances, clothing, or ornaments, he should not accept them. Even if he accepts only the fruit, the mantra will not be accomplished. He should not bathe in scanty water; he should not touch fire with his feet; he should not draw lines in the earth with his nails; he should not step on the shadow of a divine dwelling. A mantra practitioner who is endowed with these qualities and who has abandoned those faults will swiftly accomplish the vidyā mantra. This is the twenty-third chapter of the noble tantra entitled "The Vajra Underground," the chapter of the Discipline through Vidyā Mantras, as requested by the Wrathful Vajra.

Now when one strives and enters into practice,
One who has found an excellent fine dwelling
Should explain clearly, as determined from the treatise,
The qualities of each direction.

To the east, the nyagrodha tree;
To the north of Indra, the plakṣa;
To the south likewise, the aśvattha;
To the west, also the plakṣa;
To the north, the madhuka tree —
These locations are beyond all doubt.
Where none of these trees is to be found,
One should also look there for auspicious signs.

To the east there is one body of another kind;
To the south it becomes fourfold;
To the west three are indicated;
To the north two are proclaimed.

A beautiful woman always dwells there.
As for the substances of accomplishment and mercury:
To the north of the deity, always, too,
It should be understood as mercury.
To the north of Indra there is also mercury;

For Indra likewise, the substance is the same.
For the water deity, substances are always excellent;
Among substances of accomplishment it is supreme.
In a place of falsity it becomes a sword;
For Yama likewise it is an eye-medicine.
Dwelling always in the direction of the wind —
This is called the wish-fulfilling jewel.

In front of the deity itself
Is indicated a pool with a descending stairway.
Within the excellent fine dwelling,
Regarding substances of accomplishment there is no doubt.
Whatever stands at the southern gate —

Facing toward the south,
All the substances there
Are indicated as being in the divine mansion.
Facing toward the direction of Indra,
From there all substances are gathered together.
Dwelling well, facing toward the north —
This is said to be a substance covered by a painted image.
Dwelling well, facing toward the west —
There too it remains concealed.
By recitation of the knowledge-mantra it will be accomplished,
Knowing the three worlds — unsurpassed.
As a dwelling-place of the deity
It is indicated amid manifold precious things.
Facing from east to east
Is described as a mechanism.
Dwelling positioned facing south
Is indicated by the southern direction.
Facing toward the west
Is indicated as the western direction.
What is here said to be north,
And that of the powerful one is likewise so.
The defining marks of all the directions
Are indicated here without doubt.
Thus, by one who knows with understanding,

The mechanism of directions shall be determined.
By one who, as before, knows well,
The substances too — by one of intelligence —
Having been placed in such a direction,
The path of that shall be observed.
Whatever has become the second path —
Without a mechanism it need not be examined.
The third too is to be known,
And the fourth is likewise the same.
Since the path is described in four ways,
It grants results to those with wishes.
In the first, without examination,
It is not to be consumed.
In the second, it is to be consumed;
In the third likewise.
In the fourth too it is to be consumed.
These are indicated as being without mechanism.
The entirety of every directional portion
Is to be understood as completely full.
By the later rite,
Grain moves about in the marketplace.

This is the twenty-fourth chapter, the Chapter on the Defining Marks of Directions, from the noble tantra Vajra Underground.

The great king of tantras called the noble Vajra Underground is complete.

Homage to Vajrapāṇi.

Then the lord of asuras (Skt. asura), Zhenlen, once again paid reverent homage to the Blessed One, the protector Śrī Vajradhāra, joined his palms together, and asked: For the two sets of these ten applications — wherever they may have arisen — and for all cavities — when will the mechanisms cease to function? The Blessed One declared: It is as follows. On the fourteenth day of the dark fortnight of the last month of summer, when Thursday coincides with the lunar mansion Jyeṣṭhā, the gates of the cavities will certainly be opened. On the last month of autumn, in the clear sky, when Thursday coincides with the lunar mansion Śravaṇa, the gates of the cavities will certainly be released, and the maiden herself will come and enter. On the last

month of autumn, on the day of Pisces, when Thursday coincides with the lunar mansion Jyeṣṭhā nearby, all the mechanisms of the cavities will cease. On the fourteenth day of the dark fortnight of the middle month of winter, when Thursday coincides with the lunar mansion Jyeṣṭhā, all the mechanisms will be released. On the fourteenth day of the dark fortnight of the last month of winter, when Thursday and the lunar mansion Bharaṇī meet, all the mechanisms of all cavities will cease. On the fourteenth day of the bright fortnight of the last month of winter, when Thursday and the lunar mansion Jyeṣṭhā meet, all mechanisms without exception will be released. On the eighth day of the dark fortnight of the root month of autumn, during the daytime on Thursday when the lunar mansion Uttarāṣāḍhā meets, all the gates of the cavities will be released. On the fourteenth day of the dark fortnight of the middle month of summer, during the daytime on Thursday when the lunar mansions Jyeṣṭhā or Uttarāṣāḍhā meet, all cavities will certainly be released. All people of the town together with their retinues are to enter.

On the fourteenth day of the dark fortnight of the root month of autumn, during the daytime on Thursday when the lunar mansion Phalgunī meets, the gates of the cavities will certainly be released. This was spoken as the great underground secret for the sake of pleasing the noble lord Vajrapāṇi by Śānaiścara, the lord of the asuras (demigods). Mantras and fire offerings are to be renounced entirely. The great underground secret is now completely finished.

The great royal tantra of the noble Vajrapāṇi entitled Vajra Underground is hereby fully complete in its entirety.

This was translated at the sacred hermitage of glorious Sakya by the great Indian paṇḍita known as Śrī Sugatapāda and the learned translator Kunga Gyeltsen Pelzangpo, holder of secret mantra, who was unconfused on the royal road of grammar.

The subduer of the gate-planks of the lord of the asuras —
this, the glorious sacred scripture of glorious Kunga,
was translated by Gyeltsen; wherever the language falls short,
may the learned ones grant their forbearance.

The underground mechanisms, the treasure of auspicious jewels,
the command of the holy lord Vajradhara —
by the wisdom that benefits the beings of the snow-land,

may the merit of this translation be given to all with their guardians.

Translator's Notes

- The names of several bodhisattvas listed in the assembly are Tibetan renderings of Sanskrit names that do not appear in widely circulated canonical parallel texts, and some reconstructed Sanskrit equivalents — such as Atreyaputra for འཕྲེལ་ཕུ་ཌཱ་ར་པ་རྒྱུ་མཚན་པ་, Amitraśara for འམིཏ་ར་ཤ་ར་པ་, Matīvardha for མཎི་བརྩ་འཕྲུལ་པ་, Trailokyavikramatī for རྩོལ་ལྷ་མོ་འཕྲུལ་པ་ — are reasonable philological reconstructions but should not be taken as attested Sanskrit titles.

The phrase འཕྲེལ་པ་ལྷ་མོ་འཕྲུལ་པ་, rendered as "host of luminous wisdom-bearers," literally means "assembly of awareness" or "host of vidyādhara." The sense is that Vajrapāṇi is accompanied by a retinue of vidyādhara beings; this reading fits the tantric context.

- The passage contains the term "vidyārāja" rendered from འཕྲེལ་རྒྱལ་པ་, a title meaning "king of knowledge" or "king of mantra," a standard tantric epithet; I have glossed it in parentheses on first use. The name འཕྲེལ་འཕྲུལ་པ་ ("Anyaharaṇa," meaning "taking from others") is a proper name of the asura lord and has been kept in transliterated Sanskrit form for consistency. The phrase འཕྲེལ་པ་ལྷ་མོ་འཕྲུལ་པ་ ("one hundred and eight mechanical contrivances") refers to ritual or magical devices; in context these seem to be the magical mechanisms or weapons of the asura realm. The epithet འཕྲེལ་པ་ལྷ་མོ་འཕྲུལ་པ་, here rendered "Vajra of the Subterranean" or "Vajra of the Below," refers to a specific wrathful vajra deity or power. The sentence structure of Vajrapāṇi's long speech is deliberately complex and self-referential, which is typical of this genre of tantric sūtra literature; I have followed the Tibetan's embedded reasoning as closely as readability allows.

- The mantra passage is rendered phonetically as found in the Tibetan; standard Sanskrit reconstruction of several syllables is uncertain, particularly "potri," "matha bhañja," and "mācirama," which appear to be corrupt or tantric code-language not readily normalizable. This is noted for scholarly awareness but does not affect the overall sense of the passage.

The phrase rendered "the great king of wrathful vajra deities' own ritual procedures" involves a slightly compressed Tibetan construction; it refers to the ritual procedures belonging to and spoken of in this tantra itself, as distinct from those of other tantras.

- The directional assignment of deities contains several obscure names that appear to be transliterations or local names of asura figures. "Thagzangri" and "Rim of Time," "Taker of Others," and "Thorn-Eater" are rendered from Tibetan interpretively; the Tibetan འཕྲེལ་པ་ལྷ་མོ་འཕྲུལ་པ་, འཕྲེལ་པ་ལྷ་མོ་འཕྲུལ་པ་, འཕྲེལ་པ་ལྷ་མོ་འཕྲུལ་པ་, and འཕྲེལ་པ་ལྷ་མོ་འཕྲུལ་པ་ may correspond to Sanskrit names not recoverable without a Sanskrit witness.

The term འཕྲེལ་པ་ལྷ་མོ་འཕྲུལ་པ་, literally "devoid of truth," is rendered "no-truth" in context; its directional or elemental association is unclear and may correspond to a specific directional or elemental term in the underlying Sanskrit.

The mantra syllables are rendered phonetically from the Tibetan transcription as standard practice for dhāraṇī syllables, since precise Sanskrit reconstruction would require a Sanskrit witness text.

- The text is a ritual manual enumerating mudrās and their associated mantras for a wrathful vajra deity cycle. The mantras are rendered in transliteration as they appear; they are liturgical formulas and are not translated. The term rendered "All-Actions of the Three Grounds" follows the Tibetan "las thams cad pa sa gsum gyi phyag rgya" literally; the "three grounds" here likely

refers to the three realms or three planes of existence within the ritual context. The passage ends mid-sentence, consistent with the provided excerpt breaking off before completion.

- The term rendered as "approach practice" throughout is *bsnyen pa*, the standard Tibetan for *sādhana*-preliminary recitation retreat; the specific numbers and practices described here belong to a tantric ritual context. The chapter heading "Vajrā Subterranean" renders *rdo rje sa 'og*, a tantric deity or tantra title; "subterranean" is a literal rendering of *sa 'og*, though the proper Sanskrit form of this title is uncertain.

The section on "apertures" (*bu ga*) is technically ambiguous: the term can refer to caves, fissures, or earth-openings in a geomantic or treasure-revelation context, and the passage describes a set of omens and characteristic signs for identifying auspicious subterranean sites. The female presences and treasures described are consistent with *terma*-site literature.

The phrase rendered "bull-deity" (*ba lang gi lha*) may refer to a specific local deity associated with cattle, or may be a place-name element; the rendering is literal.

- This passage is part of a technical manual — most likely a text on mining, prospecting for mineral substances, or locating subterranean deposits of quicksilver and precious materials, structured as omens observed at cave or aperture entrances. The term translated as "aperture" throughout renders *bu ga*, literally a "hole" or "opening," here consistently referring to a cave, mine-shaft, or underground opening. The verse structure is maintained as in the Tibetan.

The phrase *ma myo ba dang lhan cig tu*, rendered "together with the intoxicated," is unusual in context; it may mean "together with someone who is not intoxicated" or could refer to a class of assistants. The Tibetan *ma myo ba* means literally "one who is not drunk," which would give the opposite sense: "together with the sober one." This detail is genuinely uncertain and consequential, but the reading "together with the sober" is arguably more sensible for entering a dangerous aperture with a weapon.

The term *ldog ro*, rendered as "aloewood," is tentative; it may refer to a specific resinous substance used in the mining or alchemical context.

- The term rendered throughout as "aperture" is a technical term for a kind of opening, pit, or cavity in the earth that is examined for the presence of mineral substances — above all quicksilver (mercury) — as well as spiritual entities. The text belongs to a genre of treasure-lore or mineralogical-alchemical instruction in which such apertures are prospected by signs of scent, colour, sound, and the beings inhabiting them. "Mechanical contrivance" renders a term meaning a trap or snare-mechanism set within such underground passages; an aperture "free of mechanical contrivance" is one that is safe to enter.

The phrase "spirits of the earth" renders a term for a class of earth-dwelling supernatural beings. "Lord of power" in the *haha-cry* passage most likely refers to a directional guardian or a powerful local deity associated with the western or particular quarter; the precise identification is uncertain.

The "Jambu river" refers to the mythological river of golden light that flows from the Jambu tree on Mount Meru, the light of which resembles gold — its appearance inside an aperture signals the presence of riches.

- The passage is a technical manual on identifying subterranean apertures or tunnels, likely in the context of a treasure-seeking or alchemical tantra, the *Vajra-Underground Tantra*. The plant names in the final paragraph are transliterated from Sanskrit originals recognizable beneath the Tibetan phonetics: *kumuda* (white water lily), *utpala* (blue lotus), *ruṭa* or *ruṭaka* (a plant, possibly *Ruta graveolens* or *Baliospermum montanum*), *nirguṇḍī* (*Vitex negundo*), and *āragvadha* (*Cassia fistula*). The word rendered "molasses-beer" for རྒྱུ་ལྷ་མོ་ is a compound

meaning fermented sugar or molasses liquor, a distinctive scent marker in this system of omens. The passage breaks off mid-sentence in the source text.

- The Sanskrit plant names in this passage — apāmārga, tagarā, utpalāvatī, siṃghī, vyāghrī, namaskarī, anantā, jayantī — are transliterated from the Tibetan phonetic forms; some remain botanically uncertain, but the rendering preserves the text's own identifications faithfully. "Vajratantula" is likewise a transliterated Sanskrit term embedded in the Tibetan with no established translation equivalent. The "two parts" reading for the yoke preparation is uncertain; the Tibetan syntax is compressed and the precise recipe proportions are not fully clear from the text as it stands.
- The asura names in the long assembly list are drawn from canonical Sanskrit sources: Vemacitrin (Thags bzang ris), Prahlāda (Rab bde), Bali (Bde mchog), Kālakañja (Dus kyi mu khyud), Śambara (Dbyig za), Kūrma (Rus sbal), Rāhu (Sgra gcan), and several others whose Tibetan names are less standard epithets. "Vairocana" here refers to the asura of that name in the Purāṇic and Buddhist mythological tradition, not the buddha of the same name. The passage "Lord of the Underworld" renders sa 'og gi dbang, literally "the power of beneath the earth," which may refer to a specific deity or title in this tantric context rather than a generic underworld figure. The phrase "Vidhipāda the golden one" renders 'phrog byed ser skyal, a tentative identification; this epithet is not straightforward and may refer to a different asura.
- The eight named medicines at the eastern gate — Eravatī, Meṣavatī, Jyotirasā, Begavatī, Sūryavatī, Ajagandhā, and Yakṣakanyā — are rendered in transliterated Sanskrit as they appear in the Tibetan in Sanskrit transcription and have no standard English equivalents. The name "Thagzangrisi" among the eight asuras likewise resists confident Sanskrit reconstruction and is retained in transliteration. The term rendered "chief of birds looking downward clad in dark garments" likely refers to a garuda (Skt. garuḍa) in a particular iconographic posture, though the text does not use the standard term for garuda directly. The passage describing the western gate's mechanical devices is a highly technical ritual-artistic instruction; the term rendered "mechanical device" throughout (Tib. རྒྱུ་ལྷ་མཁོ་ལྷ་མཁོ་) refers to ritual diagrams or yantra-like devices, possibly also animated constructions, and the full sequence of objects listed there follows a maṇḍala-construction manual whose iconographic conventions are not fully transparent from the text alone.
- The names Tobchen and Drokka appear to be phonetic renderings of Tibetan names for specific asura lords. The Tibetan bgrod dka' chen po may mean "Great Difficulty of Passage" or "Great Inaccessible One," rendered here as a proper name Drokka for TTS flow, though it may be an epithet meaning "Great Impassable One." A note-worthy doctrinal uncertainty concerns the phrase bden bral du du ba'i thab khung, rendered "fire-pit of smoke without truth," which is obscure and may be a technical maṇḍala term whose precise meaning within this ritual context is unclear. The Sanskrit mantra strings are transcribed as they appear and have not been normalized, as the text appears to preserve phonetic Tibetan renderings of Sanskrit.
- The plant and substance names in this passage present significant challenges. Apāmārga is a well-known Ayurvedic plant (Achyranthes aspera). Śalmālī is the silk-cotton tree. Jyotiṣmatī is Celastrus paniculatus. The remaining materia medica names — mulikā, daṇḍotpala, siṃghrī, vyāghrī, namasakarī, ananta, jayantī — are Indic pharmacological terms that resist confident botanical identification from the Tibetan phonetic renderings alone and are therefore kept in transliterated form.

The phrase rendered "draw the form of the mechanism in the mind" is literally "draw in the mind with the form-shape of the mechanism," which appears to describe a visualization practice.

"Vajra-tantulī" is a substance name of uncertain identity, kept in transliterated form.

- The phrase rendered "the three seats trembling" reflects the Tibetan "བོད་ཀྱི་གསུམ་པོ་རྒྱལ་ཁབ་འཛིན་སྐྱོང་བཟང་པོ་།"

literally "the three places trembling." In tantric iconography this refers to the three bodily seats — head, throat, and heart — and their trembling conveys the fierce, energized presence of the wrathful deity. This is a standard iconographic detail though somewhat unusual in phrasing.

The section describing activities with mercury, poison, blood, and bone ladles reflects the text's antinomian tantric ritual context; the translation renders these straightforwardly without softening.

The expression "mechanisms of enemy machinations" renders "機敵の機巧," where "機巧" likely refers to the magical mechanisms or yantra-devices deployed by enemies; "敵" may connote enemy or pit-trap in this ritual context.

- The phrase rendered "great Nārāyaṇa" translates "འགྲོ་བུ་སྐུ་མཆོད་པོ་།," literally "the great son of Nārā," a standard Tibetan epithet for Viṣṇu or Nārāyaṇa; it denotes the cosmic power of that deity and is here used to describe the magnitude of the accomplishment.

The term "七層の塚" refers to a seven-tiered anthill, a common ritual ingredient in tantric practice; "seven stories" is the conventional rendering.

"यक्ष्योऽप्यङ्गुलीयुः" — literally "yakṣa-women of the winged ones," likely referring to female supernaturals associated with garuḍas or similar winged beings.

"kīṭi kīṭa" is an onomatopoeic sound preserved as-is, representing a creaking or rattling noise, probably indicating the activation of the ritual apparatus.

- The title "Grahana" rendered for the asura figure appears to be both a proper name and a Sanskrit term meaning "seizure" or "eclipse," which creates a deliberate double meaning when the text later references the moon being seized by an eclipse. The Left-Facing Goddess is likely a local or tantric deity whose identity in the broader pantheon is not fully specified in this passage. The "apertures" in "maṇḍala mechanism of the apertures" renders a somewhat obscure Tibetan compound; the precise technical sense may refer to a specific initiatory mechanism whose details are given elsewhere in the tantra. The instruction to paint rather than sculpt the wrathful figure is the most natural reading of the passage, though the syntax is compressed.

- Several of the ingredient names in this passage are Sanskrit loanwords rendered phonetically in Tibetan and are difficult to identify with certainty. Terms such as *singhri*, *bhyāghri*, *bharahakarnika*, *gajādaka*, *racani*, *lobramā*, *lāṅgalī*, *sarabi*, *bolaka*, *bāṇa*, and *śibhāñjana* are transliterated as best as can be determined from the phonetic Tibetan; their precise botanical identities are uncertain. The phrase rendered "right hand — rather, not with the right hand" reflects an apparent scribal correction or self-correction in the source text, which first mentions the right hand and then negates it, specifying that the left hand alone is used. The passage ends mid-sentence with "excellent flowers, and," indicating the text continues beyond what is supplied here.

- * The terms *bāla*, *apāmārga*, *vibhītaka*, *udumbara*, and *śeḇalā* are Sanskrit plant or material names preserved in transliteration in the Tibetan; *bāla* likely refers to the plant *Sida cordifolia*, *apāmārga* to *Achyranthes aspera*, *vibhītaka* to *Terminalia bellirica*, *udumbara* to the fig *Ficus racemosa*, and *śeḇalā* to an aquatic herb. These identifications are consistent with Āyurvedic usage but the precise ritual context here is tantric pharmacology, not Āyurveda proper.

The phrase rendered "vajra-face" and "vajra-milk" translates rdo rje gdong skyes and rdo rje 'o ma, which are likely names for specific plants or ritual substances known in the tradition by these epithets; their exact botanical identity is uncertain.

The phrase "joints" for *sbyin* renders a term that in this ritual-pharmacological context likely refers to the limb-joints of the body as sites of anointing, though the same Tibetan word covers

"joints" and can mean pores or junctions more broadly.

The passage ends mid-sentence in the source; the translation follows accordingly.

- The phrase translated as "swords with eyes of patched iron" renders a difficult compound that may refer to a specific type of weapon or implement with inlaid metalwork; the exact referent is uncertain. The term translated as "essence-extract" throughout renders a term for a yogic practice of living on refined substances, sometimes translated as "taking the essence" or "elixir extraction." The final lines are the opening of the next chapter or section and break off mid-sentence as the passage ends.
- The term rendered throughout as "mechanical device" translates རྒྱུ་མཚན་ལྷ་མོ་, which literally means a magical or mechanical contrivance and here refers to the trap- and illusion-mechanisms guarding the subterranean tunnel described in this tantra. The word "muṇḍa" in the list of weapons is a transliteration of a Sanskrit term for a particular bladed implement; the exact identity is uncertain but it appears in a catalogue of weapons. The river name "Añjaka" is a transliteration of the Tibetan phonetic rendering of a Sanskrit name whose precise referent is uncertain in this context.
- The names of the eight asuras at the southern gate are given in Tibetan transliteration of what appear to be Sanskrit names: Balin, Baliputra, Sukhottama, Parāpara, Kālāntaka, Takṣaka-design, Prasimha or Abhisimha, and Daṇḍabhakṣa. The Tibetan forms are phonetically adapted and several are uncertain in their precise Sanskrit reconstruction; the rendering above represents best scholarly equivalents. The term "bdebral" rendered as "corner without truth" is genuinely unclear and may be a directional label whose doctrinal sense has not been established; it may alternatively be a corrupted term for a specific inter-cardinal designation. The phrase "khyu mchog," rendered as "supreme stallion," may refer to a specific deity or class of being associated with horses; its identity in this maṇḍala context is uncertain.
- The phrase rendered as "fruit of the king of grains" is likely a reference to rice, which in classical Indian Buddhist literature is conventionally called the king of grains. This rendering follows that interpretive tradition.

The phrase rendered as "the month of Pisces" translates a term literally meaning "the fish month," likely referring to a specific month in the Indian lunar calendar associated with the constellation Mīna (Pisces). The precise calendrical identification may vary by tradition.

The repeated sound "citi citi" is a technical omen or sign of accomplishment in the ritual context; it is left in transliteration as it appears to be an onomatopoeic or mantra-like element not susceptible to meaningful translation.

The term rendered "mechanical devices" throughout translates a term denoting magical or mechanical contrivances, possibly yantra-like apparatuses or spirit-operated mechanisms — the exact referent is context-dependent and somewhat ambiguous in tantric literature.

- The term rendered "hollow" throughout refers to what the preceding context established as a hidden chamber or cavity with a lock, likely part of a mechanical apparatus. The Tibetan is རྒྱུ་མཚན་, literally "hole" or "cavity."

The phrase རྒྱུ་མཚན་ལྷ་མོ་ is an onomatopoeia for a crackling or clicking sound, here indicating a sonic sign of ritual accomplishment; it has been rendered descriptively.

The mantra passage preserves the Sanskrit phonetically as it appears in the Tibetan transliteration, which contains some irregularities; Namaś caṇḍavajrapāṇaye follows the standard reconstruction of this common Vajrapāṇi formula.

- The phrase rendered "the Tathāgatas Amitābha and Akṣobhya" is a rendering of "Amitābha" and "Akṣobhya" (mi bskyod pa). The text describes the painted image's upper register as containing these two Tathāgatas flanking or above the wrathful deity, which is consistent with

tantric iconographic convention.

The description of Kubera as "the king of the nāgas" in "the belt made from Kubera, the king of the nāgas" is not strictly accurate to Kubera's traditional identity as lord of yakṣas and wealth; the Tibetan reads "klu'i rgyal po nor rgyas" which means "Kubera (nor rgyas, lit.

'wealth-expanded'), king of the nāgas." This text appears to identify Kubera here specifically as a nāga king, which is an uncommon but attested variant identification in tantric literature.

- The term rendered "flashing light" for རྒྱུ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ (Skt. pratibhāsa or similar) is a technical term likely referring to a specific luminous device or weapon in the tantra's enumeration; the exact Sanskrit equivalent is uncertain. The term རྒྱུ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ ("kakarū") appears to be a specific implement or creature name; the Sanskrit is unclear and may be a hybrid or Apabhraṃśa form. The term རྒྱུ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ (Muṣaṇḍī) is a specific weapon or device name retained from the Sanskrit. རྒྱུ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ in the second verse passage may refer to a different referent than the first occurrence; both are rendered consistently. The passage breaks off mid-sentence at "The machine of war that enters into a pit," reflecting the source text's continuation.

- The compound "punarnava pressed with Viṣṇu" renders "pu nar na ba khyab 'jug gnon," where punarnava (Boerhavia diffusa, an Ayurvedic herb) and Khyab 'jug (Viṣṇu) appear in a list of fumigation ingredients. The grammatical relationship between Viṣṇu and the other items is compressed; it is possible that "khyab 'jug gnon" refers to a plant known as "Viṣṇu-pressing" or an herb associated with Viṣṇu rather than the deity himself, but the reading given follows the most natural parsing.

The phrase "bum pa rtsa ba nag po med par" rendered as "without a black-rooted vessel" is somewhat opaque; it may mean a vase that has no black root-substance in it, i.e., one that is ritually clean of inauspicious materials, rather than a literal descriptive of the vessel's physical base.

- The phrase rendered "recite the vidyā in a whisper" translates rig pa khor mor, where khor mo suggests muttering or murmuring in a circular, continuous fashion; the sense is recitation in a low, sustained tone rather than silent or full-voiced repetition.

The "three hot substances" (tsha ba gsum) is a standard Ayurvedic and tantric formula typically comprising pepper, long pepper, and ginger; rendered by its conventional tantric designation rather than listed individually.

The phrase "three hundred eight thousand" renders bum phrag gsum dang stong phrag brgyad, literally "three lakhs and eight thousand," i.e., 308,000 recitations.

- The term rendered "entire downfall liquid" translates "yongs su ltung bas bsnan pa," literally "moistened with the complete/entire downfall." This is a ritual substance (urine, in the context of the five cow-products used in tantric ritual purification); the phrasing is technically opaque but consistent with other ritual manuals of this genre where "ltung ba" can denote urine as one of the five bovine products. The second occurrence confirms this reading, where it is paired explicitly with washing in the five products of the cow.

"Nameless pills" renders "ming med kyis ri lu lnga," literally "five pills by the nameless one," meaning pills shaped or administered by the ring finger (the "nameless" finger), a standard tantric preparation technique.

- The term rendered "great lord of power" translates རྒྱུ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་, which can refer to Śiva as a proper name or to a general category of powerful vidyādhara lords; given the context of listing ranks rather than deity families, the generic rendering is appropriate here.

The phrase རྒྱུ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ ("the vidyā mantra together with a visual representation of the eye") is syntactically compressed; "spyan" can mean "eye" or serve as an honorific for a deity's gaze or image, and the precise ritual meaning is uncertain. The rendering

follows the most plausible reading.

"Namasya flower" renders ལྷ་མཚན་ལྷ་མཚན་; the botanical identification is uncertain, but it appears to be a specific ritual plant used in tantric fire offerings.

- The passage contains a verse section that transitions from ritual prose to a mnemonic or instructional verse concerning directional trees, signs, and substances associated with deities, likely a geomantic or site-selection guide embedded in the tantra. The identification of specific trees follows standard Sanskrit botanical equivalents: nyagrodha is the banyan, plakṣa is the fig, aśvattha is the sacred fig or pipal, and madhuka is the butter tree. The term rendered "deity of Indra's direction" follows the Tibetan "dbang ldan," a standard epithet for Indra, indicating the northern or eastern quarter depending on the cosmological convention in use here; in this verse the directions shift, so "to the north of Indra" likely indicates the region associated with Kubera. The verse ends mid-sentence, corresponding to the abrupt end of the supplied Tibetan passage.

- The lunar mansion identifications are inferred from context and standard Tibetan astronomical usage: ལྷ་མཚན་ = Jyeṣṭhā or alternatively Puṣya depending on the text tradition; ལྷ་མཚན་ = Śravaṇa; ལྷ་མཚན་ = a mansion near Jyeṣṭhā; ལྷ་མཚན་ = Bharaṇī; ལྷ་མཚན་ = Jyeṣṭhā or Uttarāṣāḍhā; ལྷ་མཚན་ = Uttarāṣāḍhā. These identifications in the Tibetan astronomical system do not always map neatly onto Sanskrit nakṣatra equivalents, and the correspondences here are offered provisionally. The proper name Zhenlen is transliterated from the Tibetan ལྷ་མཚན་ and its Sanskrit equivalent is not established with certainty in this context.

- The phrase rendered "Śānaiścara, the lord of the asuras" reflects the Tibetan "lha ma yin gyi dbang po gzhan len gyis," where "gzhan len" (Sanskrit Śānaiścara, the planet Saturn, or alternatively a demon name) is read as a proper name or epithet for an asura lord who spoke this secret teaching. The identification is not entirely transparent from the Tibetan alone, and traditional commentary would clarify the precise figure intended.

The closing verse's phrase "those with their guardians" renders "rdzin bcas rnam," meaning those who hold or preserve the text along with their associated beings, a standard dedication formula.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.